

CM hears grievances, orders time-bound resolution

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta held a public hearing at the Chief Minister's Janseva Sadan on Wednesday. The Chief Minister directly interacted with citizens from across the city, hearing their complaints and directing officials to ensure time-bound resolution based on the seriousness of each case.

The Chief Minister said the Government's doors must always remain open to citizens, who should be able to approach the administration directly, have their concerns heard with sensitivity, and not be forced to make repeated rounds of Government offices for a resolution. She



described this approach as the working culture of the current Delhi Government.

During the hearing, citizens raised issues spanning education, pending award money, waterlogging, sew-

erage, electrical safety, sanitation, illegal construction and unauthorised connections. The Chief Minister heard each case and directed concerned officials to conduct investigations, take

necessary action and ensure resolution within a defined timeframe. She particularly emphasised sensitive handling of matters concerning student safety and education, and stressed prioritis-

ing complaints that had remained pending for extended periods.

Several citizens told the Chief Minister they had earlier submitted complaints to relevant departments, but their issues remained unresolved despite considerable time having passed. The Chief Minister directed officials to review such long-pending complaints on priority and move forward with administrative action wherever required. She said the purpose of a public hearing was not merely to listen to grievances, but to see them through to actual resolution.

Women who attended the hearing expressed considerable enthusiasm over the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana.

Several women from different parts of the city greeted the Chief Minister and voiced their confidence in the scheme, expressing happiness over the release of the first instalment of ₹2,500 to eligible beneficiaries starting September 1.

Some citizens attending the hearing also brought handmade Laddu Gopal idols for the Chief Minister, presenting them as gifts and extending Janmashtami greetings on the occasion.

The public hearing forms part of a regular practice by the Delhi Government to allow direct citizen access to top officials for grievance redressal, with the Chief Minister personally reviewing complaints and issuing

directions for follow-up action across departments.

The range of issues raised, spanning civic infrastructure, education, safety and financial disbursements, reflected the broad scope of concerns citizens bring to such public hearings, with the Chief Minister's office indicating that each case would be tracked individually rather than treated as a general grievance to be addressed collectively.

The enthusiastic response from women regarding the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana coincided with the scheme's rollout phase, with the first round of monthly financial assistance reaching eligible beneficiaries just as the public hearing was held.

27-year-old held in Delhi-Assam psychotropic drug network

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Police, in coordination with Assam Police, apprehended a 27-year-old man from the Narela area for allegedly supplying psychotropic tablets to an interstate narcotics network with suspected links to the banned ULFA(I).

The accused, Apurba Thakur, was wanted in connection with a case registered at Mathurapur police station in Assam's Charaideo district under the provisions of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act and Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), police said.

The case dates back to July 17, when Assam Police intercepted a car on Dhodor Ali Road in Majgaon and allegedly recovered 46.11 grams of heroin concealed in soap boxes inside a hidden compartment of the

vehicle. The occupant, identified as Manuj Gogoi of Dibrugarh, was arrested and a case was registered in this connection, police said.

During investigation, Gogoi allegedly disclosed the involvement of Bhaskar Gogoi, who was subsequently arrested. Examination of Bhaskar's mobile phone allegedly revealed VoIP (Voice over Internet Protocol) communications with one Debasish Dahutia and a person suspected to be a cadre of United Liberation Front of Asom-Independent (ULFA-I) — a proscribed armed separatist group.

Debasish Dahutia was later apprehended along with Bitu Hazarika, while the suspected ULFA(I) cadre was identified as Mridupawan Dahutia, who allegedly joined the outfit in 2011, police said.

Investigation subsequently led to the suspected interstate supply chain of psy-



chotropic tablets, with Thakur emerging as a Delhi-based source for the network operating in Assam.

According to police, examination of digital evidence indicated that a consignment of psychotropic tablets had allegedly been dispatched from Delhi towards Assam. However, after Bhaskar Gogoi's arrest, information about the police action was allegedly conveyed to Mridupawan Dahutia, following which the movement of the consignments was halted. On August 25, Assam Police sought assistance from Delhi Police's

Crime Branch to trace Thakur.

The accused was traced to the Narela area, apprehended and handed over to an Assam Police team. He was subsequently arrested by Assam Police after completing legal formalities and produced before a Delhi court, which granted four days' transit remand to take him to Assam for further investigation. Through interrogation and examination of Thakur's digital devices, police allegedly found communications between him and Mridupawan Dahutia dating

back to 2025. An invoice related to a consignment of psychotropic tablets was also allegedly recovered from his mobile phone.

The financial trail is also being examined. Police said an online transaction involving several lakhs between Thakur and Bobby Gogoi — wife of accused Bhaskar Gogoi — has been detected. The purpose and nature of the transaction are being investigated.

Police said digital communications, invoice and financial transaction prima facie indicate Thakur's suspected role in the procurement and supply of psychotropic substances from Delhi to Assam.

Further investigation is underway to trace the complete supply chain of the psychotropic tablets, identify other suppliers, intermediaries and intended recipients, and examine the digital and financial trails.

GST team seizes 4.2 lakh imported cigarettes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government's GST department has seized 4.20 lakh sticks of imported cigarettes worth around ₹65 lakh. The action was taken under the provisions of the GST Act, 2017. According to the Chief Minister's Office statement, the Chief Minister has made it clear that the Delhi Government will continue to take strict action against tax evasion, the clandestine movement of goods and the illegal trade in tobacco products.

The Goods and Services Tax (GST) department has initiated major action against tax evasion and the illegal trade in tobacco products, the statement said.

During a routine inspection, an anti-evasion department of the GST branch team seized a vehicle carry-



ing around 4.20 lakh sticks of imported 'Esse Light' super-slim, premium filter cigarettes — estimated to be worth around ₹65 lakh. The action was taken under the provisions of the GST Act, 2017, it said.

The Delhi Government will continue to take strict action against tax evasion, clandestine movement of goods and illegal trade in tobacco products, it added. The consignment was being transported in violation of statutory requirements applicable to tobacco products sold or distributed in India.

NDMC suspends engineer over Lutyens' waterlogging



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

After a heavy spell of rain submerged parts of Delhi's posh Lutyens area last week, the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has suspended an executive engineer for dereliction of duty. The suspension comes days after major stretches and prominent places of the NDMC area got waterlogged on August 26, and its chairman, Manoj Kumar Dwivedi, publicly apologised for the waterlogging situation, and acknowledged that the response of the civic body had been short.

"There was more than 72 mm rainfall in less than 2 hours and this was quite unexpected, but this cannot be an excuse, and we will have to strengthen our systems to deal with such situations in future," Dwivedi had posted on X.

He said that under usual circumstances they are able to clear waterlogging within 15-20 minutes. But despite their best efforts, in at least 3-4 areas, it took more than an hour to drain it out on this occasion. Afterwards, Delhi PWD Minister and NDMC ex-officio member Parvesh Saheb Singh held a meeting with NDMC officials on the waterlogging issue in the New Delhi area and stressed that negligence will not be tolerated.

GOVT. OF ASSAM SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PWRD, HAMREN CIRCLE, HAMREN, WEST KARBI ANGLONG

SE(H)/TECH/SP-GRANT To KAAC/127(Addi)/2024-25/208

PRESS NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Office of The Superintending Engineer, PWRD, Hamren Circle, Hamren, West Karbi Anglong, on behalf of Governor of Assam invite bids for 1(one) package for Construction of Road From Amkhalam to Morten under Special Grant to KAAC for the year 2024-25 (Length=2.00 Km) in West Karbi-Anglong District of Assam amounting to Rs. 123.12 L (approx) including GST etc. from approved & eligible contractor registered with PWRD, Assam. Details may be seen from 05-09-2026 to 28-09-2026 at website- <http://assamtenders.gov.in>.

Amendment/Addendum to the SBD, if any, and further notifications shall appear in this website and also at the office of the undersigned during office hours. The contractor/bidder must be registered with the Assam e-Tendering System (<https://assamtenders.gov.in>) of PWRD, Assam

N.B. The Tender amount has been considered inclusive of (GST(12%), L/Cess(1%) etc.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer, PWRD,
DIPR/CF/PIO/1443/3-Sep-26 Hamren Circle, Hamren,

NORTHERN RAILWAY Applications are invited under scheme of 'One Station One Product' for setting up

- Total Thirteen (13) Stall at: Bahadurgarh, Delhi, Delhi Cantt, Delhi Shahdara, Ghaziabad, Gurgaon, Meerut Cantt, Meerut city, Patnauli Road, Rohtak, Samalka, Shamli, Sonapat.
- Total forty (40) Trolley at: Anand Vihar Terminal, Asawati, Baghpat Road, Ballabgarh, Baraut, Delhi Azadpur, Delhi Kishan Ganj, Delhi Safdarjung, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Deoband, Faridabad, Faridabad New Town, Garhi Harsaru, Jakhhal, Jind, Khatauli, Julana, Khakra, Mangolpuri, Mansa, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Nangoli, Narela, Narwana, Naya Ghaziabad, Noida, Okhla, Palam, Partapur, Sahibabad, Sakoti Tanda, Sampla, Shakurbasti, Shivaji Bridge, Tapri, Tilak Bridge, Tohana, Tughlakabad, Vivek Vihar.
- The period for setting up of stall/Trolley at Delhi Jn., Kurukshetra, Palwal, Gurgaon, & Meerut Cantt, Narela, Rohtak, Julana, Sampla Railway Stations per spell will be 90 days.
- Registration fee for NSG 1, 2, 3 stations will be charged @ rate of Rs. 2000 for each spell of thirty days and for NSG 4,5,6 (Delhi Kishanganj), Deoband, Okhla, Shamli, Tapri, Jind, Jakhhal, Tohana, Mansa, Narwana, Baghpat Road, Khakra, Nangoli, Muradnagar, Khatauli, Meerut Cantt, Julana, Sampla, Shivaji Bridge, Tilak Bridge, Ganaur, Tughlakabad, Faridabad New Town, Ballabgarh, Palam., Delhi Safdarjung, Partapur & Sakoti Tanda Railway Station registration fee will be charged @ rate of Rs. 1000 for each spell of thirty days.
- The following are the eligibility criteria for participant viz.
- Holder of Artisans/Weaver ID card issued by Development Commissioner Handicraft, Development Commissioner Handloom, or by the requisite state/Central Government Authority.
- Individual artisans/weavers/craftsmen enrolled/registered with Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India Limited (TRIFED) National Handloom Development Corporation (NHDC)/Khadai/Village Industries Commission (KVIC)/associated with Social Organizations, State Govt. bodies and associated with registered micro enterprises on the Udyam Portal of the Ministry of MSME and NGOs etc.
- Self Help Groups registered with PMEGP (Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme).
- Marginalized or weaker sections of society.
- No separate logo shall be allowed.
- The applicant will have to submit an undertaking to the Station Superintendent indicating that no activity would be undertaken to adversely affect the train operations, passenger safety and image of the Railways.
- Applications should be addressed and can be submitted to Station Superintendent at station by the applicant till 15:00 hrs. of 08.09.2026, which will be opened on same day.
- Station Superintendent will make priority roster of all approved participants and priority will be established through a draw of lots conducted at the station in the presence of all approved applicants by the Station Manager/Sectional CMI and nominated Finance representative.
- The One Station One Product scheme shall be governed by Railway Board's Commercial Circular No. 12 of 2022 and 09 of 2023 respectively available at Website: www.indianrailways.gov.in & URL: https://indianrailways.gov.in/railwayboard/uploads/directorate/traffic_comm/Comm_Cir_2022/OSOP%20Policy.pdf & https://indianrailways.gov.in/railwayboard/uploads/directorate/traffic_comm/Comm_Cir_2023/CC%20%2009%20of%202023.pdf For any queries applicant may contact Station Superintendent or CMI of the respective stations.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3025/26

FORM NO. INC-26
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of Span Mechnotronics Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: **"53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"**
For and on Behalf of
Span Mechnotronics Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323
Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

FORM NO. INC-26
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of Naina Estates Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: **"53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"**
For and on Behalf of
Naina Estates Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323
Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PWRD, HAMREN CIRCLE, HAMREN, WEST KARBI ANGLONG

No.SE(H)/TECH/SP-GRANT To KAAC/127(Addi)/2024-25/207

PRESS NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Superintending Engineer, PWRD, Hamren Circle, Hamren, West Karbi Anglong on behalf of Governor of Assam invite bids for one (1) package for Construction of Road from 8 no. Tamulbari to Jatangnala under Special Grant to KAAC for the year 2024-25 (Length=2.20 Km) in West Karbi-Anglong District of Assam amounting to Rs. 151.19 L (approx) including GST etc. from approved & eligible contractor registered with PWRD, Assam. Details may be seen from 05-09-2026 to 28-09-2026 at website- <http://assamtenders.gov.in>.

Amendment/Addendum to the SBD, if any, and further notifications shall appear in this website and also at the office of the undersigned during office hours. The contractor/bidder must be registered with the Assam e-Tendering System (<https://assamtenders.gov.in>) of PWRD, Assam.

N.B. The Tender amount has been considered inclusive of (GST(12%), L/Cess(1%) etc.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer, PWRD,
Hamren Circle, Hamren, West Karbi Anglong
DIPR/CF/PIO/1442/3-Sep-26

FORM NO. INC-26
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of Shree Bihari Estates Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: **"53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"**
For and on Behalf of
Shree Bihari Estates Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323
Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

FORM NO. INC-26
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of Future Solutions Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: **"53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"**
For and on Behalf of
Future Solutions Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323
Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

Government of Goa
DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM
Palyatan Bhavan, Pattoo, Panaji-Goa
Tel: 0091 (0)832-2494200/11 Fax: 0091 (0)832-2494227
Web: www.goatourism.gov.in Email: dir-tour.qoa@nic.in
No.3/(5420)0&M-Toilet(Miramar)/2026/DT/2964 Sept. 02,2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTICE (E - TENDERING MODE ONLY)

Department of Tourism, Government of Goa invites e-tenders from independent private legal entity, partnership firm, Limited Liability Partnership (LLP), Private Limited Company registered under Companies Act, 2013, Public Limited Company registered under Companies Act, 2013 for the project - **DEVELOPMENT, OPERATIONS AND MAINTENANCE OF TOILET BLOCK ALONG WITH ALLIED SERVICES AT MIRAMAR ON PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP (PPP) BASIS.** Agencies interested in applying for the tender may submit their bids with complete information as required as per the tender document. The last date for submission of the bid is **25/09/2026 up to 05.30 p.m.** For detailed Tender Notice and for participation in e-tender please visit our e-tender website <https://eprocure.goa.gov.in>. Tender notice is also available on goatourism.gov.in for reference. All queries may be emailed to dir-tour.qoa@nic.in or deptgoatourism@gmail.com by 07/09/2026 up to 05.30 p.m.
DI/ADVT/1371/2026

Uttarakhand Co-Operative Dairy Federation Ltd.
Mangal Parao, Haldwani - 263139 (Nainital) Uttarakhand
पत्रांक : सी-2347 / सुग्रीवीकरण / इजी / 2026-27 दिनांक: 02 / 09 / 2026
Short Term E-Tender Notice No.: 09/1-3/UCDF-2026-27, Date-02.09.2026
Following E-tenders are invited by the undersigned, from experienced, reputed and financially sound Manufacturers/Firms/Authorized Dealers for the following works so as to reach this office on or before **14.09.2026 up to 5.00 PM**, which will be opened on **15.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.**
1 Supply and Installation of complete Microbiology Lab on Turn-Key Basis at CDL Haldwani
2 Supply and Installation of Sodium and Potassium Analyzer at Various Milk Union
3 S.I. T& C of Various Dairy equipments at Khatima Dairy
E-Tender documents may be seen and downloaded/updated from E-tender portal <http://www.uktenders.gov.in>.
General Manager (Adm)

FORM NO. INC-26
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of RVP Enterprises Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: **"53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"**
For and on Behalf of
RVP Enterprises Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323
Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

SOUTH COAST RAILWAY
VISAKHAPATNAM
Follow us on www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in
Website: www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in
Tender Notice No.
VSKP-TRS-RT-11-2026-27

Sr.DEE/TRS/VSKP acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Tender No VSKP-TRS-RT-11-2026-27, Closing Date/Time 21/09/2026-15:00 Hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.:

Name of work with its location: Fitment of Trap Chamber in Three Phase Locomotives (WAP-7 & WAG-9) for collection Coal/Dust particles from BP Train Pipe during emergency brake application, Value of Tender (₹): 11,14,606.55, Earnest Money to be deposited (₹): 2,300.00, Cost of Tender Form (₹): 2,360.00, Completion period of the work: One Year (12 Months), Bidding system: Single packet system (e-tendering).
Tender closing date and time: 21.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs, **Website particulars:** <https://www.ireps.gov.in>, **Address of the Office:** Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRS), Electric Loco Shed, South Coast Railway, NAD Post, Visakhapatnam - 530009.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/
SCoR-A283 TRS/Visakhapatnam

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that Mrs. Suman Kumari, C/o Jitender Kumar, intends to purchase a plot of land measuring of 15.52 Sq. Yards, Part of Khada No. 368, situated in the Lal Dora Abad of Village Alipuri, Tehsil Alipuri, North District, Jharkhand, U.P.-201009, which is to be purchased from Mrs. Saria Rani, W/o Pradeep Kumar, who claims to have acquired rights, title and interest in the said property by virtue of a **Notarized General Power of Attorney Agreement to Sell and Will, all dated 11.03.2016**, executed by Mrs. Babita, W/o Late Maneeet Kumar; it is further informed that the said property is proposed to be mortgaged with Shubham Housing Development Finance Company Ltd. for obtaining financial assistance. In view of the above, the notice of the General Public that certain documents relating to the title/ownership of the said property, namely: 1. Death Certificate of Mr. Ram Kumar Gupta; 2. Surviving Member Certificate of Late Mr. Maneeet Kumar; 3. Release Deed dated 30.11.1996 in favour of M/s Sunrise Property Solution, through its partners: Nar Singh, S/o Ishwar Singh are not available with the Seller and are stated to have been lost/misplaced. Any person having any claim or objection must notify the undersigned in writing within 7 days, failing which it will be presumed that there are no objections.
NCR LAW ASSOCIATES, Advocate & Consultants, A-98, Sector-09, New Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201009, Mob. Nos. 9999721152/ 9999826427

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that my client, Dharmesh Kumar, is in process to Purchasing the Flat bearing no. C-71, on 7th Floor, retreat CGHS Ltd. built on Plot no. 20, I.P. Extension Jagatpura, Delhi, from Mahesh Chand through his daughter by availing the loan from HDFC Bank Ltd. That Mahesh Chand had purchased the said property from PDI vide Conveyance Deed dated 17/02/2022. My client has informed that the following original documents pertaining to the said property are not available with his seller
1. Original Share Certificate issued by Retreat CGHS Ltd. in favour of Mahesh Chand
2. Original Allotment Confirmation issued by Retreat CGHS Ltd. in favour of Mahesh Chand
3. True Copy of Lift of members issued by Retreat CGHS Ltd. in favour of Mahesh Chand
4. Original Possession letter issued by Retreat CGHS Ltd. in favour of Mahesh Chand
All persons having any claim against or in respect of the said property, or any part thereof, by way of sale, exchange, mortgage (equitable/registered or otherwise), gift, trust, inheritance, family arrangement, maintenance, bequest, partnership, possession, lease, sublease, tenancy, license, lien, charge, pledge, easement or otherwise whatsoever, are hereby requested to notify the same in writing to me with supporting documentary evidence at the address mentioned below within 7 days from the date hereof, failing which the claim or claims, if any, of such person or persons will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned.
Kamal Kant Gupta (Advocate)
Unit No. FF-2, First Floor, Mahalaxmi Metro Tower Sec-4, Vashi, Gzb., U.P., Mob. 9810063351

Cabinet clears ease of doing business Bill with single-window nod

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a move to make doing business in the capital easier, faster, more transparent and less costly, the Delhi Cabinet has approved “the Delhi Ease of Doing Business Bill, 2026” aimed at attracting businesses and start-ups.

The Bill seeks to bring fundamental changes to the existing process for obtaining approvals, registrations, licences and other clearances for enterprises in Delhi. According to this Bill, a simple and user-friendly online system will be created where businesses can apply for approvals, registrations, no-objection certificates, consents, licences and other requirements related to their operations.

This will also include services

such as building plans, fire-related approvals, and water, sewer and electricity connections.

Citizens and businesses will no longer need to visit different government offices and submit separate applications. The Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC) will be made the single nodal agency for all business approvals provided through this single-window system.

According to Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi government is working to create a system where business owners and entrepreneurs do not have to visit different government offices, submit the same information repeatedly or wait for long periods for the necessary approvals.

Through the Bill, different business-related processes will be



brought under a system that is simple, transparent, time-bound and technology-driven.

The Bill seeks to move the relationship between the govern-

ment and enterprises away from a system based on control and suspicion towards one based on trust and ease.

The Chief Minister said the most

important feature of the proposed law would be a single-window system.

She said that for several activities included in Schedule-3 of the Bill, approval, permission, licence or no-objection certificate will be granted as soon as the application is submitted.

Self-declaration will be accepted for specified low-risk categories and cases falling within the prescribed limits. This will provide relief from lengthy approval processes for low-risk activities. For activities not covered under Schedule-3, approvals, permissions, licences and no-objection certificates will be provided within the timelines prescribed under the Right to Timely and Easy Delivery of Services to Citizens Act, 2026.

The Bill also proposes a provision for deemed approval once

the prescribed time limit expires.

This means that if the competent authority does not take a decision within the stipulated period, the approval will be deemed to have been granted in accordance with the provisions of the Bill. The Chief Minister said the burden of duplicate registrations on businesses would also be reduced.

Enterprises already registered under the Goods and Services Tax, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India, the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Act or the labour codes will not need to obtain separate registrations for trade, health-trade, eating house, or shops and establishments.

The proposed law also provides for an inspection system based on trust. No routine inspection will be carried out for three years after an

enterprise is registered. However, an inspection may be conducted if a serious complaint is received.

The Chief Minister said a negative-list-based system would be adopted to provide greater freedom to conduct business. Under this system, an enterprise will be able to carry out any activity at any location, provided the activity is not included in the negative list specified in Schedule-2 of the Bill.

According to her, these reforms will transform the many separate, interconnected, discretionary and time-consuming business processes in Delhi into an integrated, transparent, time-bound and technology-driven system.

Following its approval by the Delhi Cabinet, the Bill will now be sent to the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.

Over 2.18 lakh inclusion forms filed and 51,000 objections raised in voter list revision

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The chief electoral officer of Delhi has received a total of 2,18,139 forms for inclusion of names into the voter list and over 51,000 objections were filed for removal of voters' names till September 1 under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). As per data shared by the Delhi CEO, a total of 2,14,534 Form-6 were submitted up to August 31 and another 3605 were filed on September 1.

The claims and objection phase started on August 31 and will conclude on September 30, during which voters can file Form-6 for inclusion of their names, Form-7 for objection and removal of names, and Form-8 for change in registered address.

The highest number of Form-6 (29,510) for inclusion of names in the voters lists were submitted from the West Delhi district , while maximum objections (14,663) were filed from South East Delhi district for removal of names from the rolls, upto September 1. According to the data, West Delhi district recorded the highest number of Form-6 at 29,510, followed by South East (25446), North East (25010), North West (22189, South West (20,191), according to the data.

Out of total 51,522 Form-7 filed on first two days after publication of draft rolls on Monday, highest were from



South East (14,663), North (11,626), West (8,930) and East (2621) districts. South East district also witnessed the highest number of exclusions of voters in the draft rolls among the 13 districts in Delhi.

A total of 2,63,801 Form-8 were submitted for change in registered address by the voters. The highest number was 33,083 from East district followed by North East (32,783), South East (30,581), South (26,331) and West (25,387), showed data.

A total of 47.5 lakh voters out of 1.45 crore were removed from the draft rolls of 70 Assembly constituencies in Delhi. The final voters list of Delhi will be published on November 4.

The voters excluded from the draft roll have been marked as Absent, Shifted, Dead and Duplicate (ASDD) and others category. Officials

said that over 43 lakh voters whose names were removed came under the absent/shifted category.

The poll officials have also started issuing notices to voters whose names have been published in the draft rolls due to various mismatches and anomalies in their personal details in the forms submitted by them during the enumeration phase.

The notice and verification phase will conclude on October 29, after which the final electoral rolls will be out. More than 33 lakh voters whose names appear in the draft rolls, are likely to receive notices from the poll body.

Poll officials said that voters will receive notices if their details could not be linked to the 2002 Delhi SIR or if anomalies regarding their personal details were detected in the enumeration forms.

Ex-bureaucrat Ashish Joshi held by Delhi Police for nine hours

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police's Special Cell questioned former bureaucrat Ashish Joshi for nearly nine hours on Wednesday; however, he was later allowed to leave. Congress leader Sandeep Dikshit publicly sought information about his whereabouts. Joshi confirmed his return in a post on X at around 7.30 pm, saying that the Delhi Special Cell had dropped him home.

Police sources said Joshi, a former controller of communications in the Department of Telecommunications, was not arrested and had only been called for questioning in connection with an old case. Details and the specific context in which he was questioned were not immediately available. Joshi was brought to the Special Cell's office in New Friends Colony around 10 am and released around 7 pm.

He was questioned by a team of the Counter Intelligence unit, and his statement was recorded during the questioning, the sources said. Joshi was brought to the Special Cell's office in New Friends Colony around 10 am and released around 7 pm. In a post on X, he said, “Just got back home. Delhi Special Cell dropped me home.



Details later.” According to police, the case had been registered two days earlier under Section 192 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which deals with intentionally giving provocation with the aim of causing a riot. The offence is cognisable and bailable, police said.

The development followed allegations by Dikshit that two police personnel had taken Joshi away during his morning walk at Nehru Park and that his family and associates were unable to establish where he had been taken. Dikshit had urged senior Delhi Police officers to disclose Joshi's whereabouts, saying the family was deeply concerned.

Dikshit, who described Joshi as a close friend, said he received a call from him in the morning but could not answer it. When he tried to call back, Joshi's phone was switched off. According to

Dikshit's account, an eyewitness who was accompanying Joshi during his morning walk later informed the family that two police personnel had approached him and said they needed to question him over a recent post on social media. Dikshit said the policemen told Joshi that they were taking him to the Special Cell facility in New Friends Colony. He alleged that Joshi was made to sit in his own car, which was later found parked at the New Friends Colony police station.

Dikshit had also alleged that lawyers and others sent to the police station were initially unable to get confirmation about Joshi's whereabouts.

In a video statement, Dikshit questioned why the family had not been given information about Joshi's whereabouts if the matter concerned only a social media post.

Evening outing turns tragic as three youths drown in Sanjay Lake

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

What began as a light-hearted evening outing with friends ended in tragedy as three youths drowned in east Delhi's Sanjay Lake after they allegedly entered the water to take a dip, police said on Wednesday.

The incident took place around 7 pm Tuesday under Pandav Nagar police station limits when Ashish Nautiyal (21), Sahil (22) and Saurabh (21) had gone to Sanjay Lake together. According to preliminary information, Ashish, waded into deeper water and began to drown. When his friends saw him go underwater, they jumped into the lake in an attempt to save him. However, neither of them made it out.

Police and rescue personnel reached the spot after receiving information about the incident. Following a search operation, the bodies of all three youths were recovered from the lake. The bodies have been sent for post-mortem and further investigation into the circumstances leading to the drowning is underway, police said.

The incident has left three families grappling with loss. Ashish's father said that his son had gone to Sanjay Lake



with his friends where he drowned. “We do not know exactly what happened. But my child is lost.”

The family received a call regarding the incident, and has been inconsolable since. On the other hand, Delhi Development Authority (DDA), which is responsible for maintenance of the lake, rejected allegations that the water body has deepened due to illegal sand mining carried out by the civic agency.

“With reference to the unfortunate drowning incident, it is clarified that the claims attributing the deepening of the water body and alleged illegal sand mining to the Delhi Development Authority are factually incorrect and misleading,” the DDA said. The agency said it had neither undertaken nor authorised any sand mining at the site and termed the allegation that the water body had deepened as a result of such mining activities as “completely unfounded”.

60-year-old investor found dead, niece among 3 held for robbery-murder

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A 60-year-old stock market investor was found dead on Wednesday in his house in northwest Delhi's Rohini, with police apprehending his niece and two of her associates in connection with the robbery-cum-murder. Rakesh Khanna was found unconscious at his house in Sector 3 in Rohini on Tuesday, with his house ransacked, suggesting robbery when he was alone in the house when the incident took place.

During investigation, it emerged that the accused had learnt that the victim had recently sold some property worth Rs 75 lakh.

“Simran Taneja, niece of the victim, then hatched the conspiracy with her friend Himanshu, a gym owner, with the intention of robbing the cash and valuables,” Deputy Commissioner of Police (Rohini) Shashank Jaiswal

said.

They had conducted a recce of the house on Sunday, August 30, before executing the crime, he said. According to the officer, the accused had also attempted to commit the crime during their earlier recce but failed. They returned on Tuesday and executed the plan.

The officer said Taneja played a key role in facilitating the entry of the other accused into the house. “Taneja, a resident of Burari, allegedly took Khanna's wife and her own mother to a fair in Paschim Vihar, leaving her uncle alone at home. She later reached the house in an autorickshaw and went upstairs, asking Khanna to open the door, following which the other accused gained entry,” the DCP said.

The accused were wearing helmets, caps and masks to hide their identification, he said. “After entering the house, they



overpowered Khanna and pressed his mouth to prevent him from raising an alarm. He fell unconscious during the assault and subsequently died,” the DCP said.

The officer said that a PCR call was received at 8.14 pm on Tuesday, reporting a house theft and an unconscious person inside the premises.

“He was taken to Jaipur Golden Hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead,” he added.

“Prima facie, there were no visible injuries on the body,” he added.

The officer said that at around 7.30 pm, three persons entered Khanna's house while another associate kept watch outside.

The police said around Rs 72,400 in cash and two gold rings reported stolen from the house have so far been recovered. A preliminary investigation led the police to zero in on Taneja.

The Burari resident has prima facie emerged as the

alleged main conspirator behind the robbery and death, which she is suspected to have orchestrated with the help of her associates.

“Two of her alleged associates, Chirag (22), a resident of Burari who works as a gym trainer, and Paras (19), a class 12 student, were also apprehended in connection with the case,” Jaiswal said.

Another accused, Himanshu, also a Burari resident is absconding and efforts are underway to arrest him. According to the police, Paras was earlier booked in a criminal case at Mukherjee Nagar police station.

A case under sections 103(1) (punishment for murder), 309(4) (robbery) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita has been registered at South Rohini Police Station. Further investigation is underway to establish the precise role of each accused.

Traffic advisory issued for Janmashtami Shobha Yatra, central routes to see delays

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Traffic movement is likely to remain heavy and slow on several roads in central Delhi on September 3 due to the Shri Krishna Janmashtami Shobha Yatra in the Paharganj area. The procession is scheduled to begin at 10 am and more than 2,000 devotees, along with raths and jhankis, are expected to participate, according to a traffic advisory. Traffic movement is likely to be affected on Rani Jhansi Road, DBG Road, Chelmsford Road, Panchkuian Road and adjoining stretches during the procession.

Motorists have been advised to remain patient, follow traffic rules and cooperate with traffic personnel deployed along the route.



Security and traffic arrangements have been put in place at Laxmi Narain Mandir, popularly known as Birla Mandir, in central Delhi ahead of Shri Krishna Janmashtami celebrations on September 4, police said on Wednesday.

According to the New Delhi district police, devotees visiting

the main temple will be allowed to enter exclusively through Mandir Marg, which can be accessed from Kali Bari Marg or Peshwa Road.

Entry will be regulated through Door Frame Metal Detectors (DFMDs) installed at the main entry points, and visitors have been advised to cooperate with security personnel during checking.

Handbags, briefcases, parcels, food packets, cameras, mobile phones and other battery-operated equipment will not be permitted inside the temple complex.

The temple authorities have arranged facilities for depositing footwear near Kali Bari Marg and beside the Hindu Maha Sabha office on Peshwa Road, the police said.

DDA begins Master Plan for Delhi 2047 consultations, plans 20 stakeholder meetings

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Development Authority has begun a three-month consultation exercise with elected representatives and other stakeholders to facilitate the implementation of the Master Plan for Delhi 2047, following directions from Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu. The first consultation was held on Tuesday with three Members of Parliament and 33 Members of the Delhi Legislative Assembly.

The discussions focused



on major planning provisions, including Transit Oriented Development, High Density Corridors, land

pooling, unauthorised colonies and the Land Disposal Area.

The DDA plans to hold

around 20 stakeholder meetings over the next three months as part of the wider exercise. The consultations will bring together government agencies, service providers, industry representatives, architects, planners, residents, landowners and other groups involved in Delhi's development.

At Tuesday's meeting, MPs Ramvir Singh Bidhuri, Manoj Tiwari and Praveen Khandelwal were among those present. Thirty-three Delhi MLAs also attended the consultation. DDA Vice Chairman N Saravana Kumar

briefed the elected representatives on various provisions of MPD 2047 and issues related to its implementation.

The public representatives welcomed the DDA's efforts leading to the notification of the new master plan. They sought 15 days to submit detailed observations and suggestions in writing, according to the authority. The consultation comes as the DDA prepares to involve a broader group of stakeholders in discussions on how the provisions of MPD 2047 should be implemented across the capital.



SALE OF FLY ASH, BOTTOM ASH AND POND ASH
INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST



Vedanta Power Limited (erstwhile Taiwandi Sabo Power Limited) is one of India's leading private power producers delivering reliable power for a growing economy, that lights homes, touches lives, and drives transformation across the nation. With a total installed thermal power capacity of 4,780 MW, the company supplies power to discoms nationwide through long-term partnerships, while supporting emerging grid requirements. Its portfolio includes a 1,980 MW plant in Mansa, Punjab; a 1,000 MW facility in Nellore, Andhra Pradesh; 1200 MW in Sakti, Chhattisgarh; and a 600 MW unit in Jharsuguda, Odisha. Through operational excellence, technological leadership, and strategic capacity expansion, Vedanta Power Limited is reinforcing grid stability as a cornerstone of India's energy security.

Vedanta Power Limited invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from all users of ash for sale of fly ash, bottom ash and pond ash through open auction at a price of “INR 1/MT”. The buyer shall be off-taking ash generated from 600 MW Thermal IPP located in Jharsuguda for utilisation of ash in an environment-friendly manner, as per the prevailing guidelines of MoEF & CC, SPCB and MoP.

The open auction details are as below:

Estimated Quantity (Million Metric Tonnes)	4.5 MMT from FY 2026-27 to FY 2028-29
Submission of Documents	03.09.2026 to 09.09.2026
Date and Time of Open Auction	11.09.2026, Time 11:00 – 13:00 Hrs

*Interested and eligible MSE buyers can download the bidding documents from – www.vedantapower.com/becoming-a-supplier/
Expression of Interest to be submitted via Email Id: VedantaPower.Commercial@vedanta.co.in
For further information, bidders can log into: <https://www.vedantapower.com/becoming-a-supplier/>

After UP cracker factory blast, bulldozers raze accused’s house

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Kaushambi

Authorities have razed a three-storey house of the main accused in the illegal cracker factory blast in Manouri town while the death toll in the incident rose to 14 with one more person succumbing to injuries, officials said on Wednesday.

Superintendent of Police Satya Narain Prajapat said that Urvashi (17), who was injured in the explosion, died during treatment at SRN hospital in Prayagraj.

He said that a warehouse, owned by Kakhshan Bano, the wife of Naushad - who is the main accused in the August 31 firecracker factory blast case - was raided by police in Muratganj market.

Six sacks of firecrackers were seized from two rooms of the warehouse during the search, officials said.

A joint team of the Prayagraj Development Authority (PDA) and Kaushambi Police carried out the demolition of Naushad's house. District Magistrate Amit Pal said the house was constructed without the required building map approval and other permissions from the authority.

A bulldozer was stationed at Naushad's house at 6 pm on Tuesday and the proper-



Locals view the demolished and partially collapsed structure belonging to the owner of an illegal firecracker unit in the Manauri area of Kaushambi district PTI

ty was brought down to rubble after an 11-hour operation, they said. "The three-storey house of the main accused Naushad was completely demolished in the joint action by PDA officials and Kaushambi Police. The demolition operation continued from 6 pm on Tuesday till 5 am on Wednesday," Pal said.

On Monday night, hours after the blast in which 11 children were among the dead, the district administration

demolished warehouses linked to the illegal cracker business.

"Strict action will continue against those violating the rules," Pal said. Naushad was arrested on Tuesday. His sister-in-law Shabana and niece Saina were also held. The police are looking for three others — Shakeel, Adil and Kakhshan Begum -- and have announced a reward of Rs 25,000 each for information leading to their whereabouts.

Delhi school fan falls, girl injured



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A 12-year-old girl sustained a head injury and received nine stitches after a ceiling fan fell on her at a government school in southwest Delhi on Wednesday, officials said.

Another Class 8 student was also injured in the incident at Sarvodaya Kanya Vidyalaya in Sagarpur, they said. The incident occurred while the class was in progress and both students were taken to a nearby hospital for treatment, an official said. The Deputy Director of Education, Southwest district, has constituted a fact-finding committee to inquire into the incident and submit its report within three working days. The school principal had retired about a month ago and the matter was taken up with the district education department, the official said.

Delhi AAP chief Saurabh Bharadwaj took a swipe at Education Minister Ashish Sood. "Education Minister Ashish Sood, whenever you have time from celebrating your birthday, take time to meet the girl who sustained injury," Bharadwaj posted on X.

States push deadlines on SIR rolls

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Several States have pushed forward dates for phase three of Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of voter list from 11 to 28 days to publish their respective final electoral rolls citing various reasons.

On May 14, the Election Commission of India (ECI) had rolled out phase three of SIR in 16 States and three Union Territories involving 36.73 crore voters in a staggered manner.

The States and UTs where the SIR was rolled out are Delhi, Odisha, Mizoram, Sikkim, Manipur, Uttarakhand, Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Haryana, Chandigarh, Telangana, Punjab, Karnataka, Meghalaya, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Nagaland, Tripura, and



Representative image PTI

Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

According to available details, Maharashtra has the largest extension where the final roll has been pushed from September 7 to November 4, a 28-day delay.

Karnataka and Delhi have both received 20-day extensions, moving

20-year-old gets 1.16-kg hairball removed

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Darjeeling

Eleven years of swallowing her own hair left a 20-year-old woman with a massive 1.16-kg hairball filling her stomach, which doctors at a private hospital here removed after she developed severe abdominal pain and repeated vomiting.

The woman, a student, had been consuming strands of her own hair since she was around nine years old, a behaviour medically known as trichophagia, doctors said.

She was brought to Manipal Hospital Dwarka after suffering severe abdominal pain, nausea and repeated vomiting for three days. She also had a longer history of poor appetite, weight loss and fatigue.



A photo shows a trichobezoar (hairball) extracted from a patient's stomach during a surgery at Manipal Hospital, Dwarka PTI

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Student dies by suicide over school punishment

According to police officials, the principal told investigators that the student had sought permission to go to the washroom and was accompanied by a female staff member. The school claimed that the girl then moved towards the terrace and jumped before anyone could stop her.

Police are now examining CCTV recordings from the school premises, including corridors and other areas, to establish what happened in the period before the student went to the terrace. Investigators are also expected to examine the circumstances surrounding the alleged punishment and determine whether there was any delay in informing the family.

The student's father told reporters that a dispute had taken place among some students earlier in the day and alleged that his daughter had been singled out for punishment. He described her as a good student and said her behaviour had appeared normal before she left for school.

Police officials said the girl's parents submitted an application early Wednesday seeking a post-mortem examination. However, they had not made any allegation against the school through a formal complaint at that stage.

Further legal action will depend on the findings of the post-mortem examination and the contents of any formal complaint submitted by the family, police said.

Govt says 7.8% growth is solid, not a statistical...

The successive changes, he said, reflected the normal revision cycle and incorporation of additional information, rather than an attempt to reduce the previous year's GDP to mechanically lift the latest growth rate.

"The claim that the numbers have been compressed now relates to a number which has been released in February 2026, but which has not been quoted," he said.

He went on to stress that growth comparisons are made using estimates from the same comparable series and at constant prices, which remove the effect of price changes.

In a statement, MoSPI said revisions to last year's GDP and the divergence between different price measures reflect updated data and estimation techniques rather than an attempt to artificially boost headline growth.

The clarification came two days after the government released an updated series of annual and quarterly GDP estimates with 2022-23 as the base year, incorporating a new Producer Price Index (PPI), Banking Services Price Index and additional administrative data.

The ministry's detailed questions-and-answers addressed concerns ranging from negative implicit price deflators in manufacturing to the sharp difference between nominal and real growth in mining, as well as the sizeable statistical discrepancy between production- and expenditure-side estimates. India's economy grew 7.8 per cent in real terms in the first quarter of fiscal 2026-27, according to the revised GDP series. The ministry said a negative implicit GVA deflator for manufacturing should not be interpreted as evidence that factory-gate prices declined. Manufacturing GVA in the June quarter was compiled using a double-deflation method, under which output and intermediate consumption are separately adjusted for price changes before real GVA is derived. When input prices rise faster than output prices, nominal GVA can grow more slowly than real GVA, producing a negative implicit deflator even when both output and input prices are increasing.

Manufacturing real GVA grew 9.2 per cent in the quarter compared to nominal growth of 7.7 per cent, resulting in an implicit GVA deflator of minus 1.5 per cent, the ministry said.

It cited textiles and cotton ginning, basic metals, and rubber and plastic products among activities where input-price growth exceeded output-price growth.

The ministry also pointed to international experience, saying negative or volatile manufacturing deflators can emerge in economies using double deflation during periods of energy and raw-material price shocks.

Agriculture presents a different case because quarterly agricultural GVA is first estimated at constant prices using production data, with current-price estimates subsequently derived using the relevant producer-price index.

The agriculture, forestry and fishing output PPI rose about 5 per cent in the quarter, resulting in a positive implied inflation rate of 3.9 per cent, the ministry said.

It also rejected claims that the Q1 2025-26 current-price GDP estimate was reduced from ₹86.05 lakh crore to ₹80 lakh crore to make the latest growth rate appear stronger.

The Rs 86.05 lakh crore figure was calculated under the superseded 2011-12 base-year series and was initially published in August 2025. When the government introduced the 2022-23 base-year series in February 2026, the corresponding Q1 estimate was revised to Rs 80.32 lakh crore.

That figure was subsequently updated to ₹80.44 lakh crore when provisional FY2025-26 GDP estimates were released in June, before being revised to ₹80 lakh crore following the incorporation of the new IIP and PPI series.

The ministry said these revisions reflect the normal process of incorporating a new base year, improved data sources, updated methodologies and additional indicators.

The government also sought to explain why the implied GDP inflation rate of about 2.5 per cent can differ substantially from consumer and wholesale inflation.

The GDP deflator is an economy-wide measure derived from the ratio of nominal to real GDP. Unlike the Consumer Price Index, which tracks a defined basket of household consumption, or the Wholesale Price Index, which focuses largely on goods and excludes services, the GDP deflator captures the price effects across the economy, including investment, government spending, exports and a broad range of services.

Nepal seeks climate compensation...

Nepalese authorities described the disaster as a "Himalayan Tsunami." According to figures reported by Nepal Police as of September 1, more than 1,100 people had been confirmed dead, while thousands remained missing. Search-and-rescue operations are being conducted primarily by Nepal's security agencies.

Kathmandu has formally approached the UN-backed Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage, seeking urgent financial assistance for the disaster. The request was signed by Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle and Forests and Agriculture Minister Geeta Chaudhary. Nepal has asked for an urgent response rather than waiting for the fund's next scheduled meeting.

The government says the disaster has caused widespread deaths and displacement, destroyed critical infrastructure and disrupted livelihoods and essential services. It is seeking assistance not only for immediate relief but also for reconstruction, resettlement and specialised recovery operations.

Nepal has also mobilised its diplomatic missions to brief foreign governments and international donors about its requirements.

Foreign assistance has already been sought for specialised capabilities, including tunnel-rescue teams, forensic experts and Bailey bridges. Kathmandu had initially indicated that it would rely on its own agencies for search and rescue, but subsequently sought specialised teams, equipment and expertise from India, China and other countries.

Khanal has specifically named China, the United States and India as the world's three largest current greenhouse-gas emitters and argued that they have a responsibility toward countries such as Nepal that have contributed comparatively little

to global emissions but face severe climate-related risks.

"This is not a matter of charity; it is a matter of legal and moral liability," Khanal said.

The European Commission's EDGAR database ranks China, the US and India as the three largest greenhouse-gas emitters in absolute terms based on its latest estimates.

India's per-capita emissions remain substantially below those of China and the United States. India has also consistently argued in international climate negotiations that responsibility should be assessed with regard to historical emissions, per-capita emissions, development needs and the fact that industrialised countries benefited from decades of carbon-intensive economic growth. For that reason, Nepal's call for compensation is likely to become part of a broader and potentially contentious debate over who should pay for climate-related damage in vulnerable developing countries.

While Nepal has linked the catastrophe to rapidly changing conditions in the Himalayas, the precise trigger of the flood has yet to be conclusively established.

Initial assessments have pointed to a massive rock-and-ice avalanche or other high-altitude event near the Nepal-China border. Scientists have also raised the possibility of unstable glaciers, changing mountain conditions and broader changes in the Himalayan ecosystem.

A detailed scientific investigation will be needed to determine exactly what triggered the flood and to establish the extent, if any, to which human-induced climate change contributed to the individual event.

The region is also located in a highly seismic and geologically fragile part of the Himalayas, raising questions about the vulnerability of infrastructure and settlements to cascading natural hazards. Nepal could now take its demand directly to the global stage. According to The Kathmandu Post, the government is considering sending Prime Minister Balendra "Balen" Shah to New York to attend the 81st session of the UN General Assembly and personally raise the issue of the Rasuwa disaster and climate compensation. Foreign Minister Khanal had initially been expected to represent Nepal at the UNGA, whose general debate is scheduled to take place later in September.

If Shah travels to New York, the disaster could become a major part of Nepal's diplomatic campaign, with Kathmandu expected to press wealthy and high-emitting countries for greater financial support for vulnerable Himalayan nations. Nepal contributes only a small fraction of global greenhouse-gas emissions, yet its geography leaves it particularly exposed to melting glaciers, unstable mountain slopes, floods and other climate-related hazards.

Khanal has argued that the consequences are not confined to Nepal. Himalayan glaciers and river systems provide water to hundreds of millions of people across South Asia, making the stability of the region an issue with implications far beyond Nepal's borders.

The Nepalese government estimates that rebuilding after the disaster could cost \$4 billion to \$5 billion, equivalent to nearly 10% of the country's economy, Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle told Reuters.

The situation remains developing, with the death toll, number of missing people and extent of infrastructure damage expected to change as search-and-rescue teams reach affected areas.

ED digs into NHAH toll racket

In Jammu, investigators searched the Gandhi Nagar home and Trikuta Nagar office of businessman Rakesh Choudhary. In Kolkata, officers raided a flat on Shakespeare Sarani that serves as a city-based businessman's office.

The money-laundering investigation began after police FIRs, including FIR No. 17 dated January 22, 2025. The agency then registered an

Enforcement Case Information Report, ECIR/ASZO/04/2025, on May 19, 2025.

The complaints claim that unauthorised software was installed at several NHAI toll plazas to create receipts outside the approved system. Officials said these receipts allowed cash collected from motorists to be kept off official records, so the amounts did not appear in NHAI ledgers. ED officials said that forensic checks of digital systems and NHAI records have confirmed the use of such software. Investigators explained that a separate unauthorised application generated fake receipts, while the official plaza software recorded different transactions.

The agency is now looking into whether the diverted money was moved through accounts, cash transfers, or other methods that could fall under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

The searches aim to recover computers, servers, storage devices, copies of software, bank records, and other evidence. They also seek to identify the people and groups who may have controlled or benefited from the unauthorised applications, and to trace the proceeds of the crime. Officials said the investigation has expanded beyond individual plaza issues to a larger network that may have supplied, installed, or operated the software and managed the diverted funds. They are also checking how long the unauthorised applications were used and how many plazas they were used at. The ED said it will review bank statements, cash records, software logs, and NHAI traffic and collection data to determine whether money from unauthorised receipts was laundered.

HC orders CBI probe into Disha Salian death

The agency submitted its closure report stating that the deceased had died by suicide, but the report is yet to be heard by the court concerned.

The high court asked the CBI to register an FIR and record the statement of Disha's father, Satish Salian, but clarified that no person shall be treated as an accused until and unless there is sufficient material gathered against them during the probe. While Satish Salian sought an FIR against Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray, the high court refrained from making remarks against any individual, noting it was up to the central agency to investigate the case. Thackeray has denied all allegations. Disha's father had raised suspicion about the circumstances in which she died in 2020 and approached the HC.

The high court, in its judgment, said it was of the opinion that the police had sufficient opportunity to investigate the alleged offence, but they have not registered an FIR and have not carried out the investigation of a cognisable offence.

The high court on Wednesday ordered the Mumbai police to hand over all Disha Salian death case papers to the CBI forthwith.

"In case the investigation reveals that no case is made out, then the CBI shall file the appropriate summary report before the court concerned," the bench said.

Satish Salian would be at liberty to challenge the report, the high court said.

The HC in its order noted that Salian was an "unfortunate" father of a young daughter who lost her life in "tragic circumstances" and that the case required substantive investigation.

The court pointed out certain lacunae in the investigation carried out by the police and said the spot panchnama (where the body was found) was conducted belatedly.

It also raised doubts about the fact that no blood was found at the spot where Disha Salian had fallen to her death, and also there was no bleeding injury to her head.

"If the deceased had fallen on her face from the 12th floor, then it is difficult to accept that there was only one injury on the chin of the body. Not a single facial bone was fractured. We find this difficult to accept," the HC said.

The bench said the CBI shall appoint a suitably experienced and senior officer to probe the case. "Nobody shall be treated as an accused unless

in the opinion of the investigating officer there are sufficient grounds to raise reasonable suspicion against him depending on the material collected during the investigation," the HC said.

If any offence is made out, then an appropriate report shall be filed before the competent court, it added.

After conducting an inquiry, the police had claimed that Disha Salian's death was a case of suicide. Her father, however, filed a petition in the HC last year alleging that his daughter was gang-raped and murdered.

Satish Salian's advocate Nilesh Ojha raised doubts about the police probe into the case.

In his plea, he claimed his daughter was found dead under mysterious circumstances in June 2020. He alleged that she was raped and murdered, and subsequently there was a politically orchestrated cover-up to protect certain influential persons.

Earlier, Aaditya Thackeray had also filed an application in the HC seeking to intervene in the plea filed by Satish Salian and urged the court to grant him a hearing before passing any order. Thackeray, in his application, said the petition filed by Satish Salian was false, frivolous and motivated.

From MiG-21 to ATR, ex-group captain...

Founded by aviation industry veterans and backed by professional investors, the airline has positioned itself around the idea of making air travel more accessible beyond the country's major metropolitan centres.

That regional focus makes the ATR an important part of its operations, with the aircraft suited to short-haul routes and connectivity between smaller cities.

Varthaman's arrival comes as India's civil aviation sector continues to expand beyond the traditional metro-to-metro network, with regional connectivity emerging as an increasingly important part of the country's aviation story.

Born in Chennai on June 21, 1983, Varthaman was educated at Sainik School, Amaravathinagar, before graduating from the National Defence Academy. He was commissioned into the fighter stream of the Indian Air Force in June 2004.

During his military career, he flew the Su-30MKI before being assigned to a squadron operating the MiG-21 Bison. He rose through the ranks, serving as a Flying Officer, Flight Lieutenant, Squadron Leader and Wing Commander before being promoted to Group Captain in December 2021. The February 2019 aerial engagement, however, transformed him from a serving fighter pilot into a household name. His moustached profile, calm demeanour and the circumstances surrounding his capture and return became defining images of one of the most closely watched episodes in recent India-Pakistan relations.

Now, the next chapter of his flying career is set to unfold far away from the fighter squadron. The MiG-21 represented India's combat aviation heritage and Varthaman's years as a fighter pilot. The ATR represents another side of aviation - one centred not on interception or combat, but on connectivity. His future passengers may be travelling for work, education, business, family or simply to reach another Indian city more quickly.

The man who once flew into a contested sky is now preparing to fly across a very different one. The exact date of Varthaman's first commercial flight, and the sectors he will eventually operate, remain undisclosed at his request.

But one thing is clear: after a career defined by fighter jets, combat training and one extraordinary chapter in India's military history, Abhinandan Varthaman is preparing to fly again - this time with civilians in the cabin and connectivity, rather than combat, as the mission.

From MiG-21 to ATR, the cockpit remains - but the mission has changed.



PR can polish picture of GDP, but not economy itself: Congress slams Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Congress on Wednesday cited former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg's reported remarks on GDP numbers to attack the Modi Government, saying it must understand that "PR can polish the picture" of the GDP but not the economy itself.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh shared a video clip of Garg in which he stated that by revising last year's GDP by as much as ₹6 trillion, the current year's GDP in the first quarter has gone up by around 10.3 per cent.

"If you had not revised last year's GDP, the growth in current prices would have been 2.6 per cent," Garg told a news channel.

In his post in Hindi on X, Ramesh said that no matter how much the Modi Government beats the drum of



Congress leader Jairam Ramesh

its fabricated GDP growth, conjured up through statistical jugglery by its team and media, its true reality will be exposed because what they are claiming is the complete opposite of ground realities.

"Former Finance Secretary Subhash Garg has now burst the bubble on this claim. His assessment is that the real GDP growth is around 2.6%, not 7.8%," Ramesh said.

"We want the economy to truly be strong, but the path to a strong economy doesn't come from embellishing

numbers fabricated on a foundation of lies - it comes from accepting the truth," the Congress leader said.

The Government should first acknowledge the real economic situation, then undertake reforms - jobs should be created for the youth, MSMEs and private investment should be boosted, demand and incomes should rise, economic inequality should decrease, and instead of promoting crony capitalists, fair competition should be

ensured, Ramesh said.

"The Modi Government must understand: PR can polish the picture of GDP, but not the economy itself," the Congress general secretary said.

"It's clear that on the very GDP for which Modi is urging citizens to burst crackers and celebrate Diwali, serious questions are being raised by his own former Finance Secretary," Ramesh said.

Congress' media and publicity department head Pawan Khara also lashed out at the Modi Government over Garg's remarks.

"Subhash Garg has punctured the Government's tall claims of 7.8% GDP growth, arguing that India's real GDP growth is closer to 2.6%. His contention is even more damning: the previous year's GDP growth was revised downward, making this year's growth rate look stronger by comparison," Khara said on X.

Rijiju slams Congress for questioning GDP numbers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Attacking the Congress for questioning India's GDP numbers, Union minister Kiren Rijiju on Wednesday asked if the Opposition party was in a "state of deep intoxication" or had become "so swayed by their blind loathing of India's growth that they lost touch with ground reality".

Rijiju made the remarks in a post on X in reply to a post by Kerala Congress, which said, "Nobody believes the fake story anymore. The world can see through the fakery."

The Kerala Congress also posted an image of a beer mug showing the Indian economy as the actual liquid and the official GDP numbers as fizz.

"Is the Congress in a state of deep intoxication due to drinking too much beer or Congressmen are so swayed by their blind loathing of India's growth that they have lost touch with the ground reality?" Rijiju said.



India's economy grew at a faster-than-expected 7.8 per cent in the April-June quarter, showing resilience against concerns of an economic downturn over the war in West Asia.

Gross domestic product (GDP) growth in the first quarter of the 2026-27 fiscal slowed from a barnstorming 8.6 per cent in the previous quarter, but remained well above expectations when the conflict erupted and dis-

rupted energy markets.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has termed the GDP growth a "herculean feat".

Earlier in the day, the Congress cited former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg's remarks on GDP numbers to attack the Modi Government, saying it must understand that "PR can polish the picture" of GDP but not the economy itself.

Congress general secre-

tary in charge of communications, Jairam Ramesh, shared a video clip of Garg in which he said that by revising last year's GDP by as much as ₹6 trillion, the current year's GDP in the first quarter has gone up by around 10.3 per cent.

"Had you not revised last year's GDP, the growth in current prices would have been 2.6 per cent," Garg told a news channel.

In his post in Hindi on X, Ramesh said that no matter how much the Modi Government "beats the drum of its fabricated GDP growth, conjured up through statistical jugglery by its team and media, its true reality will be exposed because what they are claiming is the complete opposite of ground realities".

The Congress has alleged that the 7.8 per cent GDP growth is "not an economic spring" and claimed it presents a "Greatly Distorted Picture" of the state of India's economy as it doesn't convey the "depressed" investment sentiment.

AIMIM spokesperson Syed Asim Waqar joins Congress

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



Syed Asim Waqar, who rose to prominence as an AIMIM spokesperson, joined the Congress on Wednesday and took a swipe at the Asaduddin Owaisi-led party, alleging that it pays lip service to removing the BJP from power but on the ground fights those seeking to dislodge the ruling party.

Waqar joined the Congress in the presence of AICC in-charge for Uttar Pradesh Rajendra Pal Gautam, UP Congress chief Ajay Rai and AICC Minority Department chairman Imran Pratapgarhi at the AICC Office at 24 Akbar Road, here.

"Under the leadership of the Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, a movement is underway across the country on issues concerning education, employment, students, women, and marginalised sections," Gautam said at a press conference after Waqar was inducted into the party.

"Rahul Gandhi ji is firmly raising the voice of every section and continuously cautioning the Government on every front. Inspired by this, senior leaders from various parties are joining the Congress Party and strengthening the hands of Shri Mallikarjun Kharge and Shri Rahul Gandhi," he said.

In his remarks, Waqar said

all those who love the country have only one objective, which is to dislodge this "anti-national" Government of the BJP and form a secular Government which works for the people's interest.

"But I felt, being in the AIMIM for so many years, that we pay lip service by stating that the BJP must be removed, but on the ground we don't fight the BJP; we fight the Congress, the SP; we are fighting every other person who wants to remove the BJP," Waqar said.

"So, I felt that if we keep fighting the Opposition and do not allow it to blossom, then we are helping the BJP. I have decided that if we are true nationalists and want to remove the BJP honestly, then our objective should be to fight the BJP. If we are fighting the enemies of the BJP, then we are friends of the BJP," he said.

"In reality, if someone is fighting the BJP across the country, it is Congress, Rahul Gandhi and his team," Waqar asserted.

SIR aimed at helping BJP win polls, SC must stop bulk deletions: Sibal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal on Wednesday alleged that the SIR being carried out by the Election Commission is an exercise aimed at helping the BJP win elections and urged the Supreme Court to stop the "bulk deletions" taking place under it.

The former Union minister also alleged that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls that is ongoing in various states is aimed at helping the BJP win elections.

Sibal's remarks came over a report in The Indian Express which claimed that in Godda district of Jharkhand, BJP agents are

seeking to delete voters, mostly from the minority community, with Booth Level Officers, who are employees of the state Government headed by the JMM-Congress, raising red

flags over the issue.

In a post on X, Sibal said, "Politics of exclusion. BJP agents: Target Muslims, seek bulk deletions. Supreme Court needs to stop this!"

"SIR is an exercise: To

manipulate the voters list. Help BJP win elections!" the Independent Rajya Sabha MP said.

Later, addressing a press conference, Sibal said that in Jharkhand, there were bulk forms called form 7 being filed by BJP workers.

"You can file bulk forms - in the sense you can get 45, take 45 of them, or 100 of them, or even 400 of them. You can file the forms, and you can say that this name should be deleted. You don't have to give any reason for it, and if it is found to be false, it doesn't matter," Sibal said.

In this particular report in a national newspaper, when an investigation was done, the names that were target-

ed belonged to the Muslim community, he said.

And those people have been interviewed, and they have said [they've] been living there for years; their families have been living there for years. So if this is the way things are going to be done, what's the point of having an election?

It has been found that those Muslims whose names were sought to be deleted by bulk forms by BJP workers were actually living there for years, many of them ever since Independence, he said.

"And therefore this is a very serious issue, and if courts don't take care of this issue, if courts just believe that the SIR exercise is by a

neutral Election Commission of India, then I think we are in deep trouble - this democracy will be in deep trouble," Sibal said.

"For example, in Delhi itself, about 45 lakh to 47 lakh names have been cut, have been deleted. Now how many will be restored, I don't know, but that's almost 23-24 per cent of the entire electorate of Delhi, which is 1.5 crore," he said.

In Uttar Pradesh, 2.05 crore names have been cut, and crores of names are being cut like this, Sibal said.

"So far about five to six crore names have been cut overall ever since this process of SIR started," he said.

TMC alleges misuse of police in West Bengal against its members

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Alleging that police were being misused in West Bengal to target her party's leaders and activists, TMC Rajya Sabha deputy leader Sagarika Ghose on Wednesday said authorities were failing to upload FIRs online and serve mandatory notices to the accused.

Addressing a press conference, Ghose said the Supreme Court has directed police to upload FIRs online so an accused can know the allegations against them,

but this direction is not being followed.

She said the FIRs should be uploaded in a manner that makes them clearly legible, alleging that police were deliberately not making them available online.

Ghose also referred to provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita under which an accused in cases carrying a punishment of less than seven years is required to be served a notice, and alleged that this requirement was also not being followed.

"FIRs are not being uploaded online, and



TMC Rajya Sabha deputy leader Sagarika Ghose

notices are not being given," she said, alleging that cases relating to incidents dating

back to 2018 and 2019 were being revived by filing fresh complaints.

"This is a conspiracy against TMC activists," Ghose alleged.

Referring to the police questioning of TMC Rajya Sabha leader Derek O'Brien in Kolkata, she claimed the senior Parliamentarian was pushed and fell, yet a complaint was lodged against him.

She said the alleged misuse of the police was part of a wider pattern of "political atrocities" and intimidation of senior TMC leaders.

"The manner in which the police are being misused in

Bengal, the Constitution, law and order are being attacked," she said.

"If the police are misused, no one will remain safe," she said. She said the party would challenge the alleged misuse of police, and also raise the issue at the international level.

"The manner in which police action is happening is a violation of human rights," she said.

The TMC was defeated by the BJP in May 2026, ending Mamata Banerjee's 15-year reign as West Bengal chief minister.

Ex-minister Karan Singh calls for setting up Himalayan authority to save mountain range

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



Veteran Congress leader and former Union minister Karan Singh on Wednesday suggested the setting up of a Himalayan authority by Himalayan nations to help save the mountain range and urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to take the initiative.

He also termed the four-laning of highways to connect the Char Dhams in Uttarakhand "reprehensible", saying the Government of India must adopt a proactive role in saving the Himalayas from destruction.

Singh also expressed deep sympathy with the people of Nepal over the loss of lives after the disaster, saying he has a special attachment to the country as his late wife hailed from the place.

"The cataclysmic events in Nepal have led to a considerable loss of life and property. I would like to express my deep sympathy with the people of Nepal in this hour of tragedy," Singh said, noting that his late wife was from Nepal, and thus, he has a special attachment to that "beautiful country" and its people.

"I must add that the event that triggered the disaster took place in Tibet. In a way, the episode has once again reminded us of the fragility of the Himalayan region. This is

why many lovers of the Himalayas, like myself, have constantly been urging that the Government of India must take some proactive role in saving the Himalayas from destruction," said the veteran leader, who is also the former governor of Jammu and Kashmir.

"The destruction that four-lane roads in such delicate areas, as the Char Dham in Uttarakhand, is reprehensible. This involves massive blasting and widening of the roads. In my view, four-lane roads should be totally banned in the Himalayas. There is no reason why tourists and pilgrims cannot travel on two-lane roads," he asserted.

"I have been suggesting for some time that the Himalayan nations should set up a Himalayan authority. This would include Pakistan, Tibet, India, all the way to Bangladesh and Bhutan. Only then can a

uniform policy be adopted. It would be appropriate if Prime Minister Narendra Modi were to take the initiative in this regard with the prime minister of Nepal," the former Union minister said.

The death toll from Nepal's devastating flash floods rose to 1,127 on Wednesday as rescuers are racing to find thousands still missing a week after the Himalayan disaster, police said.

According to the Nepal Police, 348 more dead bodies were recovered from Chitwan, 217 from Nawalparasi East, 190 from Nawalparasi West and 155 from Nuwakot.

Similarly, 66 bodies were recovered from Gorkha, 59 from Dhading, 45 from Rasuwa, and 38 from Tanahu.

So far, security forces have rescued 6,541 people from the affected areas while search operations continued for 4,858 missing people, the police said.

India sends more relief supplies to Nepal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India on Wednesday dispatched a fifth tranche of over five tonnes of essential medicines to flood-ravaged Nepal, alongside an 11-member rescue team.

The death toll from last week's flash floods in Nepal has risen to over 1,000 after rescue workers recovered more bodies from affected areas, according to Nepalese authorities.

While emergency teams have rescued more than 12,000 people, roughly 4,000 remain missing as search and rescue operations continue.

"The fifth Indian aircraft has departed for Nepal. It is carrying an 11-member rescue team with specialised equipment, and 5.5 tonnes of essential medicines," External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said

on social media.

India has already delivered to Nepal a total of 68.5 tonnes of relief materials. New Delhi had also sent a team of doctors and paramedics as well as a technical contingent along with equipment for search and rescue operations.

The first tranche of relief materials was sent by India hours after Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to his Nepalese counterpart Balendra Shah on August 26, the day flash floods struck the Himalayan nation.

Modi assured Shah of all possible humanitarian assistance to deal with the situation.

The floods have damaged 35 motorable bridges, 45 suspension bridges, and 40 km of black-topped roads, mainly in central Nepal, according to local authorities.



BJP slams actor Swara Bhasker for her Padmaavat remark

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



The BJP on Wednesday hit out at actor Swara Bhasker for her remarks on the depiction of 'Jauhar' in Sanjay Leela Bhansali's 2018 film *Padmaavat*, saying a woman should respect other women.

The BJP's response came after Bhasker criticised the depiction of 'Jauhar' in "Padmaavat", questioning the message conveyed by the film's final sequence.

"I was watching it, and I thought that if God forbid, I was a rape survivor, what is this film telling me? I would feel like a coward that I didn't commit suicide to save my honour... Are we saying that rape is the end of a woman's life? This scene was so problematic," she said at an event recently, which led to social media backlash.

Asked for a reaction, BJP national spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said, "You have taken the name of such an individual whose 'swar' (tone) has gone bad. It is said that her 'swar' (tone) also matches what is instructed to her. I understand that such kind of comments should not be made. A woman must respect other women."

Bhasker later clarified that her remarks criticising the 'Jauhar' scene in Sanjay Leela

Bhansali's 2018 film "Padmaavat" were "completely mistranslated" and she never called Rani Padmavati or other women who committed Jauhar "cowards".

The actor has been at the receiving end of social media ire over comments made during an event last week, where she said the film glorified 'Jauhar', the practise among some Rajput communities, in which women committed mass self-immolation to avoid capture, enslavement or sexual violence when defeat in war appeared imminent.

In a video posted on X on Tuesday night, Bhasker explained the context of her remarks.

"This morning, a clip of mine has been going viral on social media. It was from an event yesterday, where I was asked why I had sent

an open letter to Sanjay Leela Bhansali after watching 'Padmaavat'. While explaining what my issue was, I said something that is now being completely mistranslated and spread falsely, claiming that I had said that Rani Padmaavati and the other women who committed Jauhar were cowards," she said.

"Maine kaha tha jab main climax dekh rahi thi, mujhe laga, bhagwan naa kare agar main rape peedita hoti toh main kayar mehsoos karti ki maine aapni jaan kyun nah li, Ki main balatkar ke baad Zinda Bach gayi toh main kayar hoon (While watching the climax, I felt that, God forbid, if I were a rape survivor, the film might make me feel cowardly for not taking my own life and for having chosen to survive after the assault)," she added.

NC, BJP clash in J&K, CM Omar Abdullah alleges police bias

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

After the abrogation of Articles 370 and 35-A, the main city centres of Srinagar, including the Lal Chowk area, for the first time on Wednesday witnessed high-voltage ‘political’ protests as the ruling National Conference and the opposition Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) accused each other of failing the people of Jammu and Kashmir.

The large assembly of BJP workers and their supporters near Ghanta Ghar stunned political pundits as they raised slogans accusing Chief Minister Omar Abdullah’s government of failing on governance, jobs, and basic services. The state unit Chief and Rajya Sabha MP Satpal Sharma and Leader of the opposition, Sunil Sharma, led the protest from Lal Chowk toward the Civil Secretariat.

The National Conference workers led by their elected representatives assembled near Gindun Sports Complex in Rajbagh, attempted to march toward the BJP headquarters in Jawahar Nagar,

demanding the Centre restore statehood and honour commitments made in Parliament and before the Supreme Court.

The policemen deployed at ground zero stopped both processions. BJP workers were halted near Hari Singh High Street and Jahangir Chowk; NC protesters, including ministers and MLAs, were blocked at Rajbagh.

Both parties alleged bias in how the administration handled the two events. The NC said its peaceful protest was restricted while the BJP was facilitated and escorted by the police personnel.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah reacted strongly, accusing the police and the administration of adopting different standards while dealing with protests by the BJP and the National Conference, claiming that while the saffron leaders were escorted, those from his party were dragged.

Talking to reporters, Abdullah said that while police “facilitated” the BJP leaders during their march to the Civil Secretariat on



Police personnel stop BJP leaders and workers as they attempt to march towards the Civil Secretariat during a protest in Srinagar on Wednesday PTI

Wednesday, his National Conference (NC) colleagues were “brutally repressed”.

“You saw one protest that was denied. It showed the situation in J&K today: if you want to march on the Chief Minister’s residence, you’re allowed to; if you want to gherao the Secretariat, you’re allowed to; but if you want to protest outside the BJP’s office, God forbid, you will not be allowed, because the police are there only to protect the honour of the BJP; they don’t care about anything else,” the Chief Minister said. BJP protesters also burnt an effigy of Omar Abdullah

and raised slogans such as “*Omar teri sarkar mein andhera hai andhera hai*,” pointing to a recent electricity tariff hike and the unkept poll pledge of 200 units of free power. They also alleged outsourcing of around 24,000–25,000 Government jobs, backdoor appointments, delay in panchayat and urban local body elections, water shortages, and corruption. “The JKNC’s peaceful protest was stopped from moving forward. People were prevented from joining, and elected representatives were mishandled. Yet, when the BJP held a protest outside

the Secretariat, it was allowed to proceed. What a shame!” the NC said in a post on X.

NC MLA and chief spokesperson Tanvir Sadiq said the BJP did not fulfil its promise to restore statehood to J&K. “Where is statehood? It has been two years since the elections. The time has come to fulfil the promise made to us,” he told reporters. Demanding restoration of statehood and the constitutional guarantees revoked by the Centre on August 5, 2019, Sadiq said the NC will continue its protest till “what was snatched from us is given back”. Addressing the party workers, Leader of Opposition in the Assembly, Sunil Sharma, said the people of J&K are facing hardships, but the Government is doing nothing to address their problems.

He said the protest centred around four issues: “selling” jobs instead of conducting fair recruitment; not conducting local body polls; “rampant corruption”; and power tariff hikes.

Sharma also accused Abdullah and his party of only parroting the issue of

Statehood and not focusing on governance.

Criticising the chief minister, the BJP leader asked if people elected him to “live like a prince and go skiing in Gulmarg and Pahalgam?”

He also dared Abdullah to resign from his home constituency, Ganderbal, and seek a fresh mandate over the issue of restoration of statehood to J&K.

“If you have any self-respect left, fight an election on it (statehood). Only then will we acknowledge it as your issue,” Sharma said. He also said the issue of Statehood belonged to the BJP, as it has promised the people of J&K to restore it at an appropriate time. “If you (Abdullah) truly wish to protest on the issue of statehood, resign from Ganderbal. I challenge you from this historic venue – Crown Prince, resign over the issue of Statehood and contest a fresh election.

“If people re-elect you, we will accept that Statehood is your genuine issue. Otherwise, we will conclude that Statehood is not your

issue; it is the agenda of the BJP. Misleading the public must stop,” Sharma said. Responding to Suni Sharma’s demand for his resignation as the chief minister, Abdullah said there was no reason for him to step down.

“Why should I resign? Should we assume that they have no intention of granting statehood to this Government? If so, why are we not hearing it directly from the Centre? If they truly intend to tear the Constitution to shreds, disrespect the Supreme Court, disrespect Parliament and prove Modi’s promise as false, let them do so. I am not going to resign just to please the LoP,” Abdullah said.

The chief minister said the people of J&K gave his party a mandate for five years and he will present a report card to them. “As for the allegations (of corruption), does my government even have the authority to conduct an investigation? Let the LoP tell us what investigation was carried out. If backdoor appointments took place, which agency investigated them? Let him name just

one. “The Anti-Corruption Bureau is not under my control. The Crime Branch is not under my control. The CID is not under my control, let alone the central agencies. Tell us, where was an FIR filed?” he asked.

Abdullah also accused the BJP of making baseless allegations since it didn’t have anything else to say. “We are bearing the brunt of their mistakes; we are trying to fix them, yet they are the ones protesting,” he said.

Reacting to these simultaneous demonstrations, PDP chief Mehbooba Mufti accused the police of adopting double standards with different political parties. “The same police that won’t allow PDP to step outside its office to hold a peaceful protest on public issues have facilitated both the BJP and the NC to protest against each other,” Mehbooba said on X.

She said, “These blatant double standards must be explained – who authorises these selective restrictions and why the law is being applied differently to different political parties”.

Sikkim landslide snaps road link to SSB battalion HQ

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Gangtok

A major landslide washed away a section of a highway in West Sikkim on Wednesday, snapping road connectivity to the headquarters of the 72nd Battalion of the SSB at Yuksom and halting vehicular movement along a major tourism route.

An official release said that no casualty was reported in the landslide, triggered by heavy water flow from the Siksa Khola stream, between 6.30 am and 7 am at Rimbi



Representative image

which is around 4.5 km from the Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB) battalion headquarters.

“A large quantity of landslide debris, accompanied by a heavy flow of water from Siksa Khola, caused damage to the road on the

Geyzing-Pelling-Yuksom route, resulting in complete disruption of connectivity,” the release said. Geyzing-Pelling-Yuksom route links a tourism and historical circuit in Gyalshing district in the western part of the Himalayan State.

While Pelling offers panoramic, close-up views of the Khangchendzonga mountain range, Yuksom is the first capital of Sikkim where the first Chogyal (king) was crowned in 1642. It is also home to Dubdi Monastery, the oldest monastery in the State.

A joint inspection of the affected site was carried out by the Commandant of the 72nd Battalion, District Magistrate of Gyalshing, police officers and officials of various government departments. They assessed the extent of damage and chalked out immediate measures for restoration of the route, the release said.

On the request of the district administration, the Rescue Relief Team (RRT) of the SSB 72nd Battalion was deployed to help clear debris and reopen the road.

16th Aero India to be held in Bengaluru in February 2027

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Aero India, Asia’s largest air show and one of the world’s premier aerospace and defence exhibitions, is all set to return with its 16th edition at Air Force Station, Yelahanka in Bengaluru, from February 8 to 12, 2027, the defence ministry said in New Delhi on Wednesday.

Organised by the Department of Defence Production, Ministry of Defence, the event will bring together leading global aerospace and defence companies, policymakers, technology experts, innovators, industry stakeholders and defence forces personnel on a common



platform. Aero India has emerged as a flagship international event showcasing the nation’s growing capabilities in aerospace, defence manufacturing, emerging technologies and innovation.

It provides a dynamic platform for busi-

ness engagement, technology exchange, international cooperation and strategic dialogue, while highlighting India’s expanding defence industrial ecosystem and its growing role in the global aerospace and defence sector.

The five-day event will feature a comprehensive exhibition and a range of business and strategic engagements, providing opportunities for industry-to-industry interactions, Government-to-industry engagements, technology demonstrations and collaborations.

It will also feature spectacular aerial displays by the Indian Air Force and participating international flying teams, offering visitors an opportunity to witness advanced aviation capabilities in action.

BJP confident of winning Kolkata, Howrah civic polls

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

The ruling BJP is confident of winning more than 150 out of newly delineated 209 wards in the prestigious Kolkata Municipal Corporation elections.

Union Minister and former State BJP president Sukanta Majumdar has said that the saffron outfit was raring to go and was confident of winning more than three-fourths of the seats. “We are ready and raring to go... We are confident of winning 150 to 175 seats... We have asked our workers to get prepared for the elections and reach out to the people,” he said.

While Majumdar has been made the BJP’s charge de



Representative image

affairs of KMC elections and Rajya Sabha MP, another former State party president Rahul Sinha has been given the charge of Howrah Municipal elections.

“We do not doubt that we will win but... That is not the question... The question

is how by how many seats we will win... It will be a huge victory coming BJP’s way,” Sinha said, adding, “TMC has been thrown out of power as a most corrupt political party... While the Left has been rejected and is unlikely to leave any imprint... In

that case it is the BJP all the way.” The West Bengal State Election Commission is planning to conclude the election process by the first week of December, sources in the SEC said following a meeting of senior officials.

West Bengal Government had decided to hold civic elections to municipal boards including Kolkata, Howrah and Bally.

Most of the civic boards had been rendered non-functional after the TMC-elected representatives resigned their posts soon after this year’s Assembly elections, which saw the BJP coming to power with 209 seats. The TMC got only 80 seats, and later they were

further reduced to a nonentity following rebellion within the party, with about 62 MLAs forming a separate group out of the one led by the former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee.

Meanwhile, the break-away faction of the TMC MPs who had joined the NCPI after the State elections said that they would like to contest the civic elections as constituents of the NDA, while the BJP leadership said that they would contest the elections alone.

“We are members of the NDA and naturally would like to contest elections as constituents of the group,” said senior leader Sudip Bandopadhyay.

Suvendu drives road roller over one lakh seized drug bottles

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

In what is being viewed as symbolic of the BJP Government’s “firm commitment” to end transborder drug smuggling, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Wednesday drove a road roller over about one lakh seized cough syrup bottles at Balurghat in South Dinajpur district.

Adhikari, who was accompanied by Union Minister Sukanta Majumdar and Bengal Health Minister Shardwat Mukherjee, said that the programme was meant to send across a



message to the youth that the Government was firmly determined to end the drug menace in the State.

Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s initiative towards making India drug-

free, Adhikari said: “This is my first message to those involved in drug smuggling that the government is determined to bring the youth out of drug addiction.”

This was Adhikari’s first visit to Balurghat after becoming the Chief Minister of the State. He said that a large quantity of drug bottles had been seized in the last four months in joint operations conducted by State police and the BSF, adding, “the bottles we are destroying today are those seized bottles, sending across a straight message that we want to make Bengal drug-free.

CBI files chargesheet against 19 accused, including six Haryana IAS officers

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

On Wednesday, the Central Bureau of Investigation filed a chargesheet against 19 people. Among those accused are six Haryana-cadre IAS officers, three officials from IDFC First Bank, and one from AU Small Finance Bank. They are accused of misappropriating Rs 504 crore from several Haryana government departments and organisations.

This is the third chargesheet filed in the Haryana part of the investigation and was submitted to the Special Judge for CBI cases in Panchkula. In addition to the six IAS officers and four bank officials, nine other State Government officials

are named. They face charges such as criminal conspiracy, cheating, destruction of evidence, forgery, use of fake documents, falsification of accounts, breach of trust, abetment under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, and bribery and misconduct under the Prevention of Corruption Act.

With this latest filing, a total of 37 people and entities have now been chargesheeted in the Haryana case. Previously, the agency filed charges against 18 others, including bank officers, public servants, private individuals, and companies. Officials said 26 people have been arrested so far, and 54 searches have uncovered incriminating material, including gold worth about ₹20 crore.

The CBI says its investigation found that public servants and bankers from IDFC First Bank and AU Small Finance Bank worked together on a planned scheme. Surplus funds from eight government departments and organisations were moved from approved banks into accounts at certain branches where the accused bank officers worked, mainly at IDFC First Bank’s Sector 32 branch in Chandigarh and a branch of AU Small Finance Bank.

The agency said these transfers broke Finance Department rules on financial prudence and fraud prevention. Instead of putting the money into a real fixed deposit, as claimed, investigators say the accused used fake or non-existent fixed-



deposit receipts and false debit notes to divert the funds to unrelated third parties. The money was then moved through several accounts and converted into cash, which benefited the accused. They offered high interest rates to persuade officials to move idle Government balances into

these accounts, after which the funds were siphoned off rather than invested.

The eight entities whose funds were affected include the Department of Panchayats, the Municipal Corporations of Panchkula and Kalka, the Haryana School Shiksha Pariyojna Parishad, the Haryana Labour

Welfare Board, the Haryana State Agricultural Marketing Board, the Haryana State Pollution Control Board, and Haryana Power Generation Corporation Limited.

The largest single loss found earlier in the investigation was about ₹169 crore from HSPCB accounts. Other alleged losses of about ₹60.54 crore were linked to school education and agricultural marketing accounts that were opened in violation of state rules. Investigators also looked into suspected siphoning from the Panchkula municipal corporation and other local bodies. These issues came to light earlier this year when departments tried to close or review accounts and found big differences between recorded deposits and actual

bank balances.

Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau first registered the case in February. Because of the fraud’s size and complexity, the state government later asked the CBI to take over the investigation. The central agency re-registered the case and received approval to investigate the role of senior public servants.

Several senior officers and former bank executives had already been arrested in the earlier stages of the investigation, including those linked to the Panchkula municipal corporation, school education, agriculture, and the pollution control board, as well as former bank officials who allegedly approved account openings and debit transactions. Private individuals and shell compa-

nies named in earlier chargesheets are accused of receiving and moving the stolen money. Other CBI investigations involving Chandigarh Smart City Limited, the Municipal Corporation of Chandigarh, and CREST report another alleged diversion of about ₹153 crore. This brings the total amount mentioned by the agency to about ₹657 crore.

The Enforcement Directorate is also conducting a separate money-laundering investigation. After the fraud was discovered, IDFC First Bank publicly reported the unauthorised transactions. The bank returned much of the principal and interest to the Haryana Government, but said its employees had worked with outsiders.



BJP alleges transfer scam in Punjab, seeks Bhagwant Mann’s resignation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Wednesday alleged corruption in the transfer and posting of officials in Punjab and demanded that Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann immediately resign to facilitate an impartial probe.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters here, party national spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia also alleged that the “cash-for-transfer” scam is happening in Punjab at the behest of Mann. Bhatia alleged that the Punjab Police is not registering any FIR in the matter to protect those involved in it despite repeated requests by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), and demanded a CBI probe into the allegations.



BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia

“Transfer-posting scam is happening in Punjab. Transfer and posting of senior IAS and IPS officials are done according to a rate card. These facts have surfaced during the Enforcement Directorate’s

probe into the matter,” Bhatia said, alleging involvement of Mann’s OSD in the scam. “Does any OSD (officer on special duty) have the power to do transfer-posting of more than 20 IAS and IPS offi-

cers and that too without any knowledge of Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann? This is impossible. It is not possible without the chief minister’s permission,” the BJP spokesperson said.

“We demand that Bhagwant Mann immediately resign as chief minister. A fair probe into this matter is only possible after Bhagwant Mann resigns,” Bhatia said, demanding a CBI probe into the allegations.

Bhatia said the “facts” presented by the ED before the Punjab and Haryana High Court in its affidavit reveal that confidential documents, draft lists of postings and transfers, and draft lists of Government policies to be implemented in the future were found on WhatsApp on the mobile phones of the “middlemen and touts”.

DMK objects to dropping farmer, teacher cases via Rule 110

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai

The Tamil Nadu Assembly witnessed heated exchanges on Wednesday over Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay’s announcement under Rule 110 to withdraw the cases registered against farmers and teachers over the past five years, with the opposition DMK questioning the use of the provision for this purpose.

Vijay told the House that during the previous regime, many cases were filed between May 2021 and April 2026 against farmers and teachers who fought for their livelihoods and rights.

Soon after the announcement, the opposition DMK’s chief whip EV Velu raised objections to the statement, charging the Government with “misusing” the rule for “political motives”.

Clarifying the opposition’s stance, Velu stated that no one objected to the chief



Tamil Nadu Assembly

protests, were withdrawn. The DMK leader claimed that the then Chief Minister MK Stalin had not used Rule 110 to announce the withdrawal of the case.

Likewise, senior DMK leader KN Nehru claimed that the State Government could not unilaterally decide to withdraw the cases and that the court had to decide in this regard. Rejecting the criticism, Assembly Speaker JCD Prabhakar affirmed that the Chief Minister had acted strictly within the procedural framework. “The Chief Minister’s announcement under Rule 110 is entirely as per the rules, and there is no lapse in standard procedure. If necessary, I can provide a detailed list of what announcements can be made under Rule 110,” the Speaker retorted. PWD Minister Aadhav Arjuna also defended the move, saying that there was no violation of Assembly rules.

minister using Rule 110 to announce welfare schemes or policy decisions essential for the public.

However, he argued that using the provision to target the previous administration by announcing the withdrawal of cases, rather than launching developmental initiatives, was uncalled for.

“Cases are registered by the police solely to maintain law and order. By using Rule 110 to announce the withdrawal of such cases, is this

Government implying that no cases will be registered to preserve law and order in the future, or that it will turn a blind eye to law-and-order issues during critical tasks like land acquisition?” Velu asked, adding that using Rule 110 to criticize a former Government goes against the rules. Similarly, Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin said during the previous DMK regime, more than 5,000 cases including those related to the Kudankulam

BJP protests Rahul’s Nashik visit over women reservation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

BJP leaders protested in Nashik on Wednesday against Congress MP Rahul Gandhi’s visit to the city, accusing his party of opposing women’s representation in Parliament and State assemblies.

The allegation prompted senior party leader and former Maharashtra chief minister Prithviraj Chavan to counter that the ruling party should first “ensure the entry of women to the RSS headquarters”. Earlier in the day, Nashik Mayor Himgauri Aher-Adake, other women BJP leaders and supporters staged a protest march in the north Maharashtra city. The protesters, many of whom wore black sarees, raised “Go back” slogans against Gandhi.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, who has been holding ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ youth outreach programmes in parts of the country, is on

a visit to Nashik on Wednesday to address the participants of its organisational revamp exercise.

“My question to Rahul Gandhi is, why does your party oppose women’s representation in the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha? Rahul Gandhi should answer this today,” Nashik BJP MLA Devayani Farande told reporters. A Constitution Amendment Bill to implement reservation for women in legislatures in 2029 and increase the number of seats in the Lok Sabha was defeated in the Lower House in April this year. It was intended to provide 33 per cent reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies.

“If the country is to be made economically strong, we have seen large-scale empowerment of women after they received reservation in local self-Government bodies. Women have become aware of their rights,” Farande said.



Women had played a prominent role in India’s history, Nashik Mayor Himgauri Aher-Adake said and criticised Gandhi for allegedly opposing the “Nari Shakti Vandan” legislation. “What has Rahul Gandhi or his party done for women’s empowerment or bringing them forward?” she asked.

The protest disrupted road traffic between CBS and Ashok Stambh for some time.

Senior Congress leader Prithviraj Chavan called the allegation a “sheer lie”.

“In 2023, when the BJP

introduced the Women’s Reservation Bill in Parliament, didn’t the Congress support it? If you want to introduce a new bill, we will support it. Congress and Rajiv Gandhi were the original introducers of the Women’s Reservation Bill. Where did your thing come from? You first give entry to women in RSS headquarters and then speak,” Chavan said.

He was interacting with the media at an MTDC resort, the venue of the Congress camp here. Chavan also claimed that the ‘Chhatron Ki

Goonj’ initiative has rattled the BJP. “(RSS chief) Mohan Bhagwat is organising programmes, Prime Minister Narendra Modi arranged the working committee meeting at the same time so that Rahulji cannot be seen on television, and Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis is addressing youths in Nagpur today. Why are you doing it?” he asked.

Chavan claimed that the BJP didn’t remember the youth for 12 years, but is remembering them today. “Why did you panic?” Chavan asked in response to a query about the BJP’s criticism of the ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ programme. Fadnavis had recently termed the event the “Congress Jitao Programme” (CJP). Meanwhile, Congress leader Manikrao Thakre said the party would oppose the SIR (special intensive revision) of the voter list, particularly the deletion of around 2 crore names from the state electoral rolls.

Rahul urges Congress cadre in Nashik to stand by ideology

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Nashik

Senior Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday interacted with office-bearers of his party’s Maharashtra unit in Nashik and urged them to stand solidly with the ideology of the party, a state Congress leader said.

The Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha arrived in the city in the morning. A party functionary said Gandhi also met senior state Congress leaders. Arif Naseem Khan, member of the Congress Working Committee, said the zilla presidents of the Maharashtra Congress have been undergoing training for the last eight to ten days.

Gandhi is participating in the training programme, which is concluding on Wednesday. “Rahul ji has met all newly elected zilla



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi being welcomed on his arrival at Nashik Airport in Maharashtra

presidents and also their families.

He gave the message to stand solidly with the ideology of the Congress and fight to ensure that people get justice,” Khan said. Earlier in the day, Nashik

Mayor Himgauri Aher-Adake, other women BJP leaders and supporters staged a protest march against Gandhi’s visit, accusing his party of opposing women’s representation in Parliament and state assemblies.

Karnataka BJP president targets Congress Govt over corruption, drought during Ballari Chalo padayatra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Raichur (Karnataka)

The BJP’s ongoing ‘Ballari Chalo’ padayatra in Karnataka, led by State president BY Vijayendra, covered 22 km on its second day on Wednesday, with the party leader targeting the ruling Congress over alleged corruption, “commission raj”, drought and diversion of funds meant for marginalised communities.

The 10-day foot march, which began at Lingasugur on Tuesday, included an assessment of drought conditions, inspection of crop damage, interactions with farmers and Dalit leaders, and a public meeting in Maski.

The padayatra is scheduled to conclude in Ballari after covering around 185 km, passing through Maski, Sindhnanur, Karatagi, Gangavathi, Kampli, Sandur and Ballari Rural constituen-



Karnataka BJP President BY Vijayendra, left, along with party leaders and workers, during the second day of Ballari Chalo protest rally against the State Government at Maski in Raichur district on Wednesday

cies, according to the BJP.

Addressing reporters, Vijayendra alleged that corruption and demands for commissions had become deeply entrenched in the Congress Government.

“Even a ruling party MLA, Ashok Rai, has written to the CM against the commission system. This itself shows how deeply the commission racket has penetrated the

Government,” he said.

Referring to allegations that engineers of the Karnataka Rural Infrastructure Development Limited’s Mangaluru division had demanded a seven per cent commission from contractors executing various projects under the State Government undertaking, Vijayendra said the issue demonstrated the “level to

which the administration has fallen”.

He challenged the Congress Government to dissolve the Assembly and seek a fresh mandate if it was unable to govern the state.

“If you cannot run the Government, dissolve the Assembly and go before the people. Face elections and accept the people’s verdict. Is Congress ready to do that?” he asked.

Vijayendra demanded that all taluks facing severe rainfall deficiency be declared drought-hit and adequate relief provided to affected farmers.

He criticised the Government for declaring only 101 taluks as drought-hit despite rainfall shortages in several other areas.

“If the remaining taluks have to be declared drought-hit, perhaps farmers too have to pay a commission to the Government,” he said sarcastically.

Kharge says Congress gave food security, questions Modi Govt’s contribution in improving people’s lives

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Asserting that previous Congress Governments gave food security to people, party chief Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday said that steps by Indira Gandhi and Sonia Gandhi made lives better for the poor and questioned the contribution of the Modi Government.

Addressing an event where the Dr YS Rajasekhara Reddy Award-2026 was presented to the SSwaminathan Research Foundation, he said Indira Gandhi fought against hunger with the Green Revolution, and later Sonia Gandhi gave the ‘right to food’ to every Indian.

Kharge said the scale of the transformation can be seen clearly in the numbers from 1960-61 to 1980-81, when rice production increased by more than 50 per cent (34.6 million tonnes to 53.6 million



Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge, left, and Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy during the presentation of the Dr YS Rajasekhara Reddy Award 2026 in New Delhi on Wednesday

tonnes), while wheat production more than tripled (11 million tonnes to 36.3 million tonnes).

“Hence, the Green Revolution succeeded in transforming India from ‘beggar bowl’ to a ‘grain bowl’,” he said and also hailed the contribution of MS Swaminathan.

The Congress chief said Swaminathan was known for his contributions to the Green Revolution, when in

the 1960s India was grappling with famines and acute food scarcity and was importing food.

He said that, as a result, in the early 60s during Jawaharlal Nehru’s final term and Lal Bahadur Shastri’s brief effective regime, agricultural reforms shifted from institutional to a multifarious technological endeavour.

Then, he said, came the Green Revolution, which was one of the watershed initia-

tives of Indira Gandhi, whom he described as an ‘iron lady’, and became a key Government priority.

Recalling Swaminathan’s views, Kharge said he later wrote that Indira Gandhi understood that technology alone would not be enough — it had to be accompanied by irrigation, electricity, seeds, fertilisers, credit and effective extension services to reach farmers.

“Together, these changes transformed India’s food economy and laid the foundation for food self-sufficiency,” he said, adding that Swaminathan himself described Indira Gandhi as “the most successful warrior against hunger of this era.”

“This is the achievement of our government. But what is the achievement of the present Government, what is the achievement of Mr Modi...,” Kharge said while attacking the BJP-led Government

TN: AIKS protests evictions in Meghamalai-Varusanadu area

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai

The All India Kisan Sabha (AIKS) has launched a sharp attack on the Tamil Nadu Government and forest bureaucracy over ongoing attempts to evict traditional forest dwellers from over 5,072 hectares of land in the Meghamalai-Varusanadu areas of Theni district. The peasant body termed the action a “systemic, deliberate violation of the law” that severely mutilates the Forest Rights Act (FRA) in both letter and spirit.

According to the farmers’ union, around 25,000 people — mostly marginal peasants, Adivasis, Dalits, and Most Backward Classes spread across nine village panchayats — are currently facing



eviction in the terrain, which forms part of the Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve (ABR). AIKS alleged that the State forest department is deploying underhanded tactics by wrongfully branding long-term cultivating peasants as “encroachers”. Detailing the history of the region, the farmers’ union highlighted that revenue records, Zamin documents, historical maps, and census data conclusively demonstrate that these communi-

ties were residing and farming on the land well before it was declared a Reserve Forest and Wildlife Sanctuary.

Speaking on the unlawful measures employed by authorities, AIKS President Ashok Dhawale condemned the bureaucracy’s total disregard for statutory procedures. “The Forest Rights Act explicitly prohibits the eviction or removal of forest dwellers from forest land under their occupation until the recognition and verification procedure is complete,” Dhawale said. “The Tamil Nadu forest bureaucracy, hand in glove with the elite conservation industry, has a notorious track record in violating the FRA and manipulating laws to suppress Adivasis and traditional forest dwellers.”

Goa Assembly amends child Act to remove leprosy stigma

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Panaji

The State Assembly has passed the Goa Children’s (Amendment) Bill, 2026, seeking to remove references to “leprosy” from the State’s child protection legislation to eliminate social stigma and discrimination against people affected by the disease.

State Women and Child Development Minister Vishwajit Rane introduced the bill, seeking to amend the Goa Children’s Act, 2003, in the Assembly on Tuesday. It was later passed in the House by voice vote.

The amendment has been brought to remove social stigma and discrimination against persons affected by leprosy and bring the state law in line with a Supreme



Goa Legislative Assembly

Court order dated May 7, 2025, as per the statement of objects and reasons.

The bill sought to omit the word “leprosy” from two provisions of the principal Act. Under Section 2 dealing with definitions, the amendment removes “leprosy” from a provision that earlier referred to it along with HIV as an illness carrying social stigma.

Chhattisgarh free from Naxal menace, witnessing new dawn: VP Radhakrishnan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Raipur

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan on Wednesday said parts of Chhattisgarh had faced the grave challenge of Left Wing Extremism (LWE) for decades, but the State has now overcome the menace and is witnessing a new dawn of development, progress and prosperity.

Addressing the third convocation of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Raipur, Radhakrishnan said areas once marred by violence are increasingly being identified with roads, schools, hospitals, connectivity, investment and development opportunities.

He also highlighted women’s achievements,



Vice President CP Radhakrishnan with Chhattisgarh Governor Ramen Deka during the 3rd Convocation of AIIMS Raipur

saying that more women than men were receiving degrees at AIIMS Raipur.

For decades, parts of Chhattisgarh faced difficulties, inadequate connectivity and a grave challenge of LWE. In many of its remote and tribal areas, fear and violence became obstacles to development, he said.

“Where roads should have been built, there were bar-

riers, where schools should have flourished, there was disruption, and where hospitals and healthcare should have reached our tribal and remote communities, there was often only deprivation,” the Vice President said.

“But today’s Chhattisgarh has come out of the shadows of its past. It is a great achievement and great news for all of us.

Editor's
TAKE

SCO Summit: A win for India in Bishkek

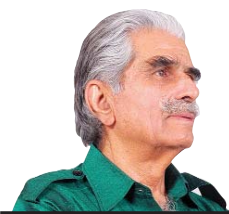
Bishkek has offered a moment of diplomatic convergence - and a reminder that declarations are easier to sign than geopolitical differences are to resolve

The 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit closed in Bishkek on September 1, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the other heads of state signing the Bishkek Declaration, marking the bloc's 25th anniversary. Hosted by Kyrgyz President Sadyr Japarov, the two-day summit brought together ten member states, fifteen partner countries and two observer nations. Prime Minister Modi's agenda rested on three pillars – security, connectivity and opportunity. On security, he pressed for dismantling the entire terror ecosystem: its financing, recruitment, radicalisation and the safe havens that sustain it, insisting there could be no double standards and that terrorism must never be treated as anyone's strategic asset. On connectivity, he backed regional trade and market integration, but only where it respects sovereignty and territorial integrity – a familiar Indian caveat aimed at projects such as China's Belt and Road corridor running through Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. What gave the moment its weight was where it happened: Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif sat at the same table, invoking his own country's sacrifices against terrorism. Yet the Declaration still carried the substance India has sought for years – a strong, collective condemnation of terrorism in every form, rejection of double standards, and a call to combat the cross-border movement of terrorists.

That every member, Pakistan included, signed on to that language is the real story, even without naming any specific attack. Beyond the rhetoric, the summit delivered India concrete institutional gains: approval of a new Universal Centre for Countering Security Threats, an updated protocol on cross-border crime cooperation that aids the fight against narco-terrorism, adoption of English as an official SCO language, and hosting rights for the SCO Civilization Dialogue Forum this autumn – thirteen outcomes in all, by the Ministry of External Affairs' own count. The summit's ambit reached well beyond South Asia. The Declaration condemned the US-Israeli strikes on Iran as violations of international law and favoured a more multipolar order over unilateral sanctions – an SCO positioning itself against Western-led institutions. That sits awkwardly alongside India's own recalibration: a February trade deal cutting US tariffs from 50 per cent to 18 per cent came bundled with a commitment to wind down Russian oil purchases, even as Modi sat with Putin in Bishkek, reviewing the full spread of India-Russia ties, energy included. With Xi Jinping there was no scheduled bilateral, just a warm handshake – modest, but consistent with the thaw since Tianjin. The real test begins now. Later this month, Modi, Xi and Putin reconvene in New Delhi for the BRICS summit, a sterner test of whether Bishkek's cordiality survives contact with unresolved friction on the border and in trade. Declaratory unity against terrorism has been signed before, Pakistan included, without reliably converting into extradition, financial action or intelligence-sharing India can point to. Bishkek gave India better language. What New Delhi does with it will decide whether this was a turning point or one more ritual repeated on schedule.

Laldenga: From insurgency to peace

In *From Guerrilla Fighter to Chief Minister*, Zoramthanga Chhangte traces the turbulent journey from the 1966 uprising through years of exile and failed negotiations to the historic Mizoram Peace Accord of 1986. The book offers a deeply personal Mizo perspective on a conflict that ultimately gave way not to enduring bitterness, but to reconciliation and lasting peace



ASHOK K
MEHTA

On August 22, Zoramthanga, a three-term (ending 2023) former Chief Minister of Mizoram and long-time President of the Mizo National Front, received his BA degree from Gauhati University, 60 years after graduating from Dhanamanjuri College, Imphal, then affiliated with Gauhati University. On June 26, the Indian Express carried in its column “40 years ago” its front-page lead as “Laldenga would be new CM of Mizoram in an MNF-Congress I coalition government”, replacing the incumbent Chief Minister Lalthanhawla, who would be his deputy CM. The Mizoram Peace Accord is one of India's most successful internal peace processes, negotiated with Laldenga by four Indian governments, culminating in PM Rajiv Gandhi's pointed efforts – this after Congress I had signed peace accords in J&K, Punjab, Assam, Nagaland and Tripura.

The story From Guerrilla Fighter to Chief Minister is told by Zoramthanga Chhangte, a Mizo who graduated from Laldenga's PA and became his most trusted aide and Vice President of the MNF. He is an eternal believer in Jesus Christ, the Lord God of his life and its turbulent trajectory. The book has 80 short chapters covering the movement in graphic detail.

A former Havildar in the Indian Army, Laldenga was fluent in English and Hindi and taught English at a local school for ₹5. The insurgency and bid for secession began on 1 March 1966 with the declaration of a Unilateral Declaration of Independence and the launch of Op Jericho, which simultaneously targeted Aizawl (capital of Mizoram), Lunglei and Champhai, along with scattered posts in Mizoram. The Army was not deployed in Mizoram at the time; only the Assam Rifles and paramilitary forces were present. Military operations were meticulously planned, combining deception, surprise and siege tactics, though the Mizo National Army (MNA) had very few weapons to start the insurgency.

The Aizawl attack had to be abandoned due to the loss of surprise, but rebels later ambushed and killed four Assam Rifles soldiers. The Aizawl Assam Rifles headquarters fell under siege, with water pipelines destroyed. MNA asked Assam Rifles to surrender as Army helicopters attempted to drop water and evacuate casualties but were unable to land. Zoramthanga writes that Gen Sam Manekshaw, then Eastern Army Commander, was wounded while flying in one of the helicopters, which is incorrect. Meanwhile, police outposts, the



THE STORY FROM
GUERRILLA
FIGHTER TO CHIEF
MINISTER IS TOLD
BY ZORAMTHANGA
CHHANGTE, A MIZO
WHO GRADUATED
FROM LALDENGAS
PA TO BECOME HIS
MOST TRUSTED
AIDE AND VICE
PRESIDENT OF MNF.
HE IS AN ETERNAL
BELIEVER IN JESUS
CHRIST, THE LORD
GOD OF HIS LIFE
AND ITS
TURBULENT
TRAJECTORY

The writer, a retired Major General, served as Commander, IPKF (South), Sri Lanka, and was a founder member of the Defence Planning Staff, now the Integrated Defence Staff

1976 peace talks resulted in MNF accepting a ceasefire and a solution within the Indian Constitution but refusing to surrender their weapons. For the Delhi talks, Laldenga was parked at 34 Gulmohar Park, a safe house, while “negotiating with one Om Mehta as Doval was doing what he is best at – divide MNF and MNA”, with partial success. The Delhi talks failed, forcing Laldenga and Zoramthanga to escape from the safe house in 1978, but Laldenga was arrested and sent to Tihar jail. Advocate Swaraj Kaushal (married to Sushma Swaraj of the BJP) got Laldenga released (in 1990, Kaushal became Governor of Mizoram, where I met him).

On July 31, 1980, the second formal ceasefire was announced, but talks failed again and Laldenga flew off to London. Brig T Sailo, whom I knew, had retired from the Indian Army and was CM of Mizoram; his son was underground. As counter-insurgency against the MNA intensified, the MNF was declared an unlawful organisation. The third ‘Quit Mizoram’ notice was given to non-tribals and Gorkhas. In April 1984, Congress won the state elections; Sailo was defeated with the help of MNF. Lalthanhawla became Chief Minister, and Laldenga returned from London. Another ceasefire was declared in December 1984 following the most intense round of talks between Congress and MNF, with the latter agreeing to lay down arms. On 30 June 1986, 20 years after MNF took up arms, Laldenga was appointed interim CM following an interim accord between Congress and MNF. It was a compromise between the central government and rebels-turned-democrats who were mainstreamed with a safe landing.

The provisions of the accord were: MNA to surrender arms, sever ties with other banned groups, MNF to accept the Indian Constitution, grant of statehood with Special Category status and Legislative Assembly, continuation of Inner Line Permit, choice of state language, grant of state university and High Court, compensation for those killed in the 1966 uprising, rehabilitation of cadres and a lot more. Zoramthanga's book is guided by faith through conflict towards a destiny of peace guided by Jesus Christ. It is dedicated to Mizoram's martyrs. The narrative is through a Mizo lens; the account of the insurgency is scant and scattered, as Zoramthanga was focused on the peace process accompanying Laldenga. Op Jericho is a revealer. While Pakistan hosting L and Z in Rawalpindi after Dacca is a mystery, China providing training and a substantial quantity of weapons is not.

The peace process is a saga of failed talks which eventually led to a unique peace accord in which Rajiv Gandhi was heavily invested. The sound accord has led to durable peace and good governance, largely due to Mizos' love for and fear of God-a must-read book.

Aizawl jail and treasury were captured. Assam Rifles declared SOS. On March 5, for the first time in India's counter-insurgency history, IAF jets strafed the MNA, and Aizawl was left pulverised and ablaze. The siege was lifted, and MNA withdrew into the jungles to fight another day.

The attacks against Lunglei and Champhai towns were successful and resulted in surrender. From 1 to 15 March 1966, barring Aizawl, major portions of Mizoram were under the administrative control of MNF, with the capture of nearly 700 weapons, colossal ammunition and ₹2 million from the Treasury. MNA rightly did not resist the advance of the Indian Army, which entered Mizoram from Silchar, advancing to Aizawl, which Zoramthanga equated with a scorched-earth operation. While Laldenga crossed into East Pakistan, MNA volunteers stayed back to protect civilians and continue the insurgency.

MNF was not welcome in East Pakistan during Gen Ayub Khan's time. Over time, MNA contingents moved to China for training and weapons. The 1971 war forced MNF/MNA to shift to Burma's Arakan hills. Ironically, MNA fought against the Indian Army along with Pakistan's SSG in the Chittagong Hills. Laldenga and his party were keen to start peace talks with India and remained in Pakistan from 1971 to 1975, during which time Laldenga and Zoramthanga met President Zulfikar Bhutto.

Secret talks were held in Kabul, Bangkok, Geneva, Hyderabad and finally Delhi. Ajit Doval, then Assistant Director, IB, Aizawl, monitored the peace talks.

After Mujib ur Rehman's assassination, MNF moved back into Bangladesh from Burma. The

What kind of world does our news create?



RAJYOGI
BRAHMA
KUMAR
NIKUNJ JI

2ND OPINION

Peaceful world has been the main aim of humanity since time immemorial and one can say this without any doubt whatsoever that media being not only the mirror of the society but also as the leader, guide and somewhat moulder of the society can play this important role to re-establish peace in the world.

Today if we take any morning news-paper in hand and have a look at its columns, we would see that most of the news covered are about events of deviant human behavior, bride burning, oppression of lower caste people by higher cast, railway accidents, floods and fires, scandals, political defections, dacoities, hostility between religious communities and warfare between countries. Is it RIGHT?

Again, presenting news in a tart, saucy, and sensation-



al fashion is another common feature. In reality, it amounts to making people addicted to sensational, hot, nerve-rattling and blood-curdling news as one makes a person addicted to over-spicy curries and excessively hot tea or very strong and lip-burning coffee.

The result is that when there is no news of a big scandal, a horrible murder, a terrific railway accident or a major racket or a calamity in a paper, readers say: “Oh Man! There is no news today; today's paper is totally tasteless.” This trend has become so common that, in journalism, it has become a saying that bad news is good news.

After reading such news day after day, the average reader becomes discouraged to see that justice, goodwill, and honesty are conspicuously absent and feels persuaded to adopt the ways of the world around them. The need for value-based journalism is thus being felt and propagated, particularly in the Asian Continent. At its recent con-

ference, the South Asian Journalists Association stressed and advocated self-regulation to uphold values in the media. These values guide us to distinguish between right and wrong, between do's and don'ts.

We must first realise that the root cause of all kinds of misery and crime lies mainly in unethical thoughts, words, and acts of man. Incidents like robberies, dacoities, embezzlement, adultery or manufacture of new destructive weapons by some countries, all these spring from what may well be called ‘impurity of thought’ or, in other words, from violence, hate, greed, etc. in the minds of men. These evils can be reduced or, even up-rooted, by tackling the root-cause itself, viz., pollution of thought, or in other words, by inculcating in people what goes today by the name of moral values, humanism or purity in the mind of man. Hence, such news, articles and features help to solve problems of the individual and the society through purity in thought, word and deed and it will do so by bringing Supreme and soul also in the world of news and views since the world has now become too materialistic and man has moved far away from his beloved Creator. Therefore, every media person should realise that a world full of peace and happiness will not arrive without a positive and constructive role for the media.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a popular columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Digital platforms reshape cinema viewing.

The way people watch cinema has changed significantly with the growth of OTT and social media. Today, a film's success depends not only on theatres and television but also on digital platforms. This transformation has created both opportunities and challenges for the Indian film industry. Social media has become a powerful tool for connecting films with audiences. Platforms such as Instagram, YouTube and Facebook allow filmmakers to promote trailers, songs and behind-the-scenes content directly to viewers. Audience reviews and online discussions can also influence a film's popularity quickly. OTT platforms have further changed viewing habits by offering greater choice and convenience. People can watch films at a time and place that suits them. This particularly benefits regional cinema, helping Kannada and other regional films reach audiences beyond their traditional geographical boundaries. However, digital platforms should not weaken the theatrical experience. Cinemas still offer a collective cultural experience that streaming cannot fully replace. The future should therefore be viewed not as a competition between theatres and digital platforms, but as an opportunity for both to complement each other and help Indian cinema reach wider audiences.

NISARGA | UTTAR PRADESH

Terrorism cannot be a strategic asset

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's assertion at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit that terrorism cannot be considered a strategic asset highlights a fundamental principle of international security. Terrorism is a threat to humanity and cannot be justified as a means of achieving political or strategic goals. Any state or organisation that attempts to exploit terror ultimately contributes to instability and insecurity. The response to terrorism must therefore go beyond expressions of concern. Terror networks must be systematically dismantled by targeting their sources of funding, recruitment, training and logistical support. Nations must also prevent their territories from being used as safe havens by extremist organisations. A common, uncompromising approach is essential, as terrorism in one country can threaten others. The SCO provides an important platform for regional cooperation. Member countries should strengthen intelligence-sharing, coordinate counter-terrorism efforts and combat terror financing. Differences should not hinder cooperation on collective security. Modi's message deserves to be translated into sustained action. Treating terror as a strategic instrument only prolongs conflict; dismantling its entire ecosystem is the only credible path towards lasting regional stability.

RUKMA SHARMA | PUNJAB

Balancing protest and public order

This refers to the news report “SC invokes special powers to scrap FIRs over CJP protests” (September 2). The Supreme Court's decision to invoke its special powers and close FIRs arising from the protests deserves attention, especially because prolonged criminal proceedings can affect students and young people for years. The court's distinction between ordinary protesters and those with serious criminal antecedents is necessary. The larger issue is how authorities handle public protests. Peaceful dissent is essential to a democratic society, but violence, destruction of property and threats to public safety cannot be overlooked. Authorities' response must be measured and proportionate. Indiscriminately registering cases against participants may create avoidable hardship and burden both the police and the courts. Clearer guidelines are needed. Police should identify individuals with credible evidence of specific offences rather than rely on sweeping action. Video recordings can help distinguish peaceful participants from those involved in unlawful acts. Accountability matters when force is excessive, or innocents are wrongly implicated. Public order and democratic freedoms can coexist. With restraint and proper investigation, both can be upheld.

SM JEEVA | CHENNAI

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

Chummalru: The art of simply being

People travelled from across the world to Arunachala, carrying questions that had troubled them for years - about the self, about suffering, about the meaning of existence. They came expecting long discourses. Instead, they found Ramana Maharshi seated in silence, his eyes calm, his presence still.

At first, visitors would ask their questions aloud, waiting for elaborate answers. But something curious happened. In his presence, the questions themselves began to quieten. Many who came confused left without a single word exchanged, their doubts dissolved not through explanation, but through simply sitting in that silence. Ramana Maharshi's teaching had a name in Tamil - “*Chummalru*” - do nothing, simply be. Not idleness, but a stillness so complete that the noise of the mind finally settles, and what remains is clarity that no words could have given.

We live convinced that answers come from more talking, more advice, more searching outside ourselves. Ramana showed the opposite - that the truth we seek is not found by adding more, but by quietening the mind enough to hear what was always there. Try it for five minutes today. Sit. Do nothing. ‘Chummalru’. See what surfaces when you stop chasing the answer.

—DAIV

Ensuring public health through regulating food items

While the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India has taken important steps to strengthen hygiene standards and regulate unsafe practices, much more needs to be done to ensure that what reaches the consumer’s plate is genuinely safe, hygienic and transparently sourced



SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL

News reports about school children falling sick after taking food served under the Mid-Day Meal Programme. News reports frequently surface about insects, frogs, lizards, rats, etc., as well as substandard raw materials like rice and pulses, with many foreign ingredients reportedly used to cook mid-day meals in schools. Schools should serve only packaged food, preferably baked food, to ensure hygiene. It will also accommodate the peculiar food habits of some children, such as avoiding onion and garlic. Thirty Parliamentarians once appealed to the Government to replace cooked food in the Mid-Day Meal Scheme with packaged biscuits procured from reputed companies recommended by the Mumbai-based Biscuits Manufacturers Welfare Association (BMWA). The Government can save money by encouraging big packaged-food manufacturers to sponsor the programme in return for publicity for their trade names. Corporates can also be asked to fund the Mid-Day Meal Scheme with packaged food supplied under Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), which is mandatory for large companies.

Extend scope of IRCTC widely to prepare packaged food for schools and trains

Units of Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC) should be set up in every district of the country and should also produce baked items. IRCTC can provide packaged food products as mid-day meals in schools and to train passengers, where there are frequent complaints about freshly cooked meals. IRCTC products can then be sold in the open market to foster healthy competition with private companies and offer quality products at economical prices. IRCTC can raise initial funding for such a mega-project through long-term, tax-free bonds. It will also provide large-scale employment, even in rural areas, preventing migration to cities in search of employment.

Opening many IRCTC units in every district will create significant employment, preventing rural youth from rushing to urban areas in search of work. Funds for setting up such a large number of IRCTC units can be generated from special long-term, interest-free IRCTC bonds that are mandatory to disclose unaccounted black money.

Appreciable steps taken by FSSAI

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) deserves praise for taking steps to make it compulsory for all eateries to display hygiene ratings on their doors. But it should be ensured that the hygiene rating is not based only on cosmetic aspects of the dining area. The rating should also cover kitchen and storage areas. It is common for rats to be in eatery stores, and kitchens to be unhygienic.

FSSAI has also taken another important step to regulate the reuse of cooking oil through repeated frying, since repeatedly fried oil is a serious health hazard. The time has come for FSSAI to make it compulsory for every eatery, however small, to install RO water purifiers and prominently display information about their installation. FSSAI should also take steps to ensure that kitchenware for vegetarian and non-vegetarian food is kept separate in eateries to respect the sentiments of vegetarian people. This aspect should also be displayed prominently and compulsorily in all eateries.

Adulterated Honey

The Supreme Court on 19.04.2021 had sought comments from the Central and State Governments on reports of adulterated honey being marketed in India, even in popular brands of renowned companies, where some special type of sugar imported from China, mixed with honey, bypasses tests as required by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI). Research by the Centre for Science and Environment says only three out of 70 samples of honey marketed in India could pass the internationally accepted NMR spectroscopy test. If the report is correct, then it is playing with the lives of Indian people because diabetic people consume honey, as it is otherwise considered safe for diabetic people. FSSAI



should adopt the internationally accepted NMR spectroscopy test for giving sale permission for honey.

Brown sugar should be compulsory

India is experiencing a severe diabetes epidemic, often termed the “diabetes capital of the world”, with an estimated 101 million people living with diabetes and another 136 million with pre-diabetes as of 2025-2026. The best way to control such a diabetic epidemic is to make it compulsory to use brown sugar for all commercial and medicinal purposes (syrops, etc.) instead of normal white sugar. Recently, a famous confectioner of Chandni Chowk (Delhi) introduced a specially prepared sweet for diabetic people. As demand for brown sugar grows, sugar manufacturers will divert production to it instead of white sugar.

Famous branded companies marketing packaged water bottles and cold drinks have dual pricing for the same product: one normal price for open-market sale, and a higher one for sale on flights, in theatres, and in five-starred hotels, etc. This anti-consumer practice must be stopped. The best is to set up water-bottling plants of Rail Neer, marketed by IRCTC, in different parts of the country.

Check use of harmful oils and animal fats

Harmful oils and animal fats are commonly used at roadside dhabas and in some eateries in the name of butter. Central and State Governments should take necessary steps so that such spurious ‘butter’ cannot be used. After the shocking incident of adulterated ghee being found in the holy prasad of laddoos at Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanam during the earlier regime, it has become necessary to take preventive steps to ensure that confectioners and eateries do not use such adulterated desi ghee. Manufacturers of desi ghee must mandatorily share the brand name and other details with the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI). Instead, such information can be made public by directing confectioners, eateries, etc., to display details of branded raw goods, including ghee and oil, at prominent places. Taking cognisance of alleged incidents of spitting and mixing urine in eateries in Uttar Pradesh, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath rightly directed that the name and address of operators, proprietors and managers be displayed at all food centres, making it compulsory for chefs and servers to wear masks and gloves, besides making the installation of CCTV cameras compulsory in hotels and restaurants. Even Minister Vikramaditya Singh of the Congress-led Himachal Pradesh government wanted to follow the same pattern. With so many Rohingyas and Bangladeshis present in India, such steps should be mandatorily taken by all States, keeping aside pseudo-secular politics. Vegetarianism is spreading fast worldwide, with World Vegetarian Day celebrated every 1st October. The Government of India should approach the United Nations to celebrate 1st October as Vegetarian Day on the lines of Yoga Day.

Only branded milk and milk products may be allowed

Considering the usual reports of unauthorised units found producing synthetic milk and spurious milk products like khoya and paneer. To ensure the supply of pure milk and milk products, at least in cities where branded milk and milk products are easily accessible, with government-owned Mother Dairy and co-operative giant Amul, apart from some other private companies like Vita, Verka, Sudha, Saras and Nandini now marketing milk and milk products, the sale of only branded milk and milk products may be permitted in cities where such branded milk and milk products are available.

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The transformation of UP’s Vantangiya community



DEEPENDRA MOHAN SINGH | MAHENDRA KUMAR SINGH

left many forest-dwelling communities marginalised. The Vantangiya community of Uttar Pradesh is a striking example. For decades, its members lived in forests, contributed to colonial and post-colonial afforestation programmes, but remained deprived of basic civic amenities and development opportunities.

The history of the Vantangiyas dates to the early twentieth century, when the British expanded afforestation programmes across North India. Poor and landless labourers were settled in forests to cultivate crops and tend tree plantations, becoming known as Vantangiyas. The community comprises people from different castes, with many from backward-caste and Dalit communities. ‘Taungya’, from Bamar, means a cultivation field on a hill. The Taungya system combines agriculture with forestry, with crops cultivated before trees are planted on the same plot. German botanist Dietrich Brandis introduced a teak-based Taungya system in Myanmar in 1856. India later adopted the system for reforestation, particularly after large-scale colonial exploitation of forests. By the early nineteenth century, England’s oak forests had been severely depleted by logging, creating a timber crisis for the Royal Navy. India’s forests consequently became an important timber source. From the 1820s, large quantities were extracted and exported. The expansion of railways from the 1850s intensified demand because wood was required for fuel and railway sleepers. As forests around railway lines were rapidly depleted, India introduced the Taungya system in 1890 to facilitate reforestation.

The Sal-based Taungya system was introduced in the Gorakhpur Forest Division in the early twentieth century and proved successful. Labourers cleared allotted plots, cultivated crops and planted Sal trees before being moved after four or five years. Independence in 1947 did not immediately change their situation. Vantangiyas continued working in afforestation programmes, owned little or no agricultural land and lived in temporary huts. Repeated displacement left many without documents establishing their citizenship or access to government welfare schemes. The situation deteriorated in the early 1980s when the Forest Department reportedly sought agreements from Vantangiyas stating that their rights over forest land would end after completion of afforestation. The community refused to sign. They were subsequently treated as encroachers, resulting in conflict in 1985 in which two people died, and more than two dozen were injured. The Vantangiyas thereafter organised the Vantangiya Vikas Samiti to articulate their demands. A significant political intervention came with Yogi Adityanath’s election to the Lok Sabha from Gorakhpur in 1998. He took up the community’s concerns both in Parliament and on the ground. Recognising that education and healthcare were essential to integration, he mobilised institutions associated with the Maharana Pratap Shiksha Parishad and Guru Shri Gorakshnath Hospital. A temporary school was established in Tinkonia No. 3 forest village in Chargawan block. Named Hindu Vidyapeeth, it became a symbol of efforts to bring education to a community that had remained outside the mainstream. Yogi Adityanath also began celebrating Diwali with residents of Tinkonia No. 3, a tradition that continues. The Forest Rights Act, 2006, provided an important legal framework by recognising the rights of Scheduled Tribes and other traditional forest dwellers. Vantangiyas in Gorakhpur obtained residential and agricultural land rights. Yet their settlements did not receive revenue-village status. This administrative exclusion meant many government programmes related to housing, healthcare, drinking water, roads, education, and MGNREGA could not be implemented effectively. The community therefore continued its struggle for recognition as revenue villages and integration into the Panchayati Raj system, receiving sustained support from Yogi Adityanath.

The decisive turning point came in 2017, when Yogi Adityanath became Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh and declared the Vantangiya settlements in Gorakhpur district as revenue villages. Settlements including Tinkonia No. 3, Rajahi Azad Nagar, Rajahi Khale Tola, Aambag and Chilibilwa consequently gained access to government welfare programmes. In 2018, projects worth approximately ₹215 lakh were launched, followed by projects worth around ₹1.32 crore in 2019. By then, 895 toilets and 788 houses had been constructed, 647 families received electricity connections under Saubhagya, 895 Antyodaya ration cards were issued and more than 600 people received Ujjwala connections. In 2020, projects worth ₹65.77 lakh-including paved pathways, community toilets, Panchayat buildings and Anganwadi centres-were inaugurated or launched. The government also provided housing approvals, ration support, uniforms, and sweaters. In 2021, the government inaugurated or launched eight development projects involving roads and other basic infrastructure. The Vantangiya experience is therefore more than a story of material development. It represents a transition from administrative invisibility to citizenship in practice. Revenue-village recognition opened the door to Panchayati Raj institutions and government schemes, while roads, houses, electricity, healthcare, education, sanitation and social-security benefits improved everyday life.

The larger lesson is that inclusive development requires more than welfare expenditure. Communities historically excluded from formal administrative structures first need recognition, documentation and institutional inclusion. The transformation of the Vantangiya villages demonstrates how administrative reform, political representation and targeted welfare programmes can combine to advance social integration.

Yogi Adityanath’s sustained engagement with the Vantangiya community — from Gorakhpur MP to Chief Minister—shows how political intervention can turn marginalised communities’ demands into policy action. The Vantangiya story thus provides an important example of how inclusive governance can restore dignity, expand citizenship and enable historically isolated communities to participate more fully in India’s development journey.

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The body remembers: Rethinking the hidden stress of childhood



PARDEEP NANGLU

social comparison, bullying, loneliness, a phone that never switches off — and a different picture emerges: children carrying more psychological weight than we credit them with, minus the emotional toolkit adults spent decades building. Not all stress is harmful - some teaches adaptation and builds resilience. What matters is the difference between stress that’s brief and manageable, and stress that turns prolonged and overwhelming. Harvard’s Centre on the Developing Child calls the second kind “toxic stress”: excessive or repeated activation of the body’s stress-response systems, especially when a child lacks stable relationships that help them recover.

Left unaddressed, it can shape a developing brain and other biological systems in lasting ways. Adults also underestimate how large a small problem can feel to a child. Because emotional regulation, perspective-taking and impulse control are still developing, something that looks minor from outside — a friendship fallout, a bad exam, a sharp scolding — can register internally as closer to a crisis. Modern neuroscience keeps confirm-

ing what ancient traditions long assumed: mind and body aren’t separate systems. When a child perceives a threat, the brain signals the autonomic nervous and endocrine systems together — heart rate climbs, muscles tighten, breathing shifts, cortisol enters the bloodstream. If safety returns, the body settles back towards baseline. The trouble starts when a child’s nervous system keeps receiving one message: you are not safe. Researchers call this accumulated cost “allostatic load”, and a growing body of research traces how early adversity becomes biologically embedded through interconnected neural, immune, metabolic and hormonal pathways.

This is why a stomachache, headache, disrupted sleep, withdrawal, aggression or slipping grades deserve curiosity rather than judgement. They aren’t always simple “bad behaviour” — they can be the body’s vocabulary for a feeling the child has no words for yet. The CDC notes that ordinary fears and sadness are normal parts of growing up, but persistent or extreme symptoms are worth a professional look. The more useful question for parents and teachers isn’t “how do I stop this behaviour” but “what has changed?” Has a sociable child gone quiet? A once-confident one turned fearful? Is perfectionism creeping in? Has sleep or appetite shifted? Are aches appearing with no obvious cause? Is the child avoiding school, friends or activities they used to enjoy? These shifts are information, not defiance.

A child rarely announces distress in clinical language. It shows up instead as “I don’t want to go to school”, a slammed door, a long silence, or an



unexplained stomachache.

How the adult responds matters enormously: a calm parent signals safety. At the same time, a reactive one can unintentionally deepen the child’s fear — part of why an adult’s own emotional regulation is itself a form of child mental-health care. It also means resisting the urge to fix, correct or lecture. A struggling child often needs an attentive adult, phone down, asking “what happened?” instead of “why did you do that?” — and validating the feeling while holding a boundary on the behaviour: I understand you’re angry, but hitting isn’t okay. That distinction, honouring emotion without excusing harm, is foundational to healthy development.

India’s contemplative traditions — yoga, meditation, pranayama, Ayurveda — have explored the links between breath, awareness and well-being

for millennia. They aren’t a replacement for evidence-based care, but when combined thoughtfully with it, they add real value: teaching a child to notice a thought or feeling without instantly reacting - a few conscious breaths, a mindful walk, a moment of gratitude, quiet attention to nature-builds genuine self-regulation.

Research increasingly supports this. A 2024 meta-analysis of mindfulness-based interventions in children aged 6 to 12 examined outcomes including attention, cognitive flexibility, emotional and behavioural regulation, distress, social competence and physical health — part of a wider case for cautious optimism. The goal isn’t permanently placid children; it’s helping them notice what they feel clearly enough to respond, rather than react.

Psychological care that ignores the body is incomplete. Is the child sleeping, moving and eating enough, spending time outdoors, connecting meaningfully with others? The WHO recommends children and adolescents aged 5 to 17 get an average of at least 60 minutes of moderate-to-vigorous activity daily, with vigorous, muscle- and bone-strengthening activity built in regularly-movement that supports fitness, cognition, and mental health together. Sleep matters as much: a chronically exhausted brain cannot regulate emotion well. Then there’s the digital world every child now carries in their pocket — an endless stream of comparison and stimulation. The American Academy of Paediatrics notes that digital media can disrupt sleep, activity, and emotional regulation, even as it also offers learn-

ing, creativity, and connection. The answer isn’t a blanket ban but thoughtful, family-level boundaries on when and how it’s used.

One way to hold this together: regulate — breathing, emotional awareness, movement, steady routines; relate — secure relationships where a child feels seen and safe; restore — sleep, play, nature, nutrition, creativity, genuine rest. Schools have a role too, teaching emotional vocabulary, conflict resolution and self-compassion as basic life skills, not just crisis response. None of this works alone — parents, teachers, counsellors, paediatricians and communities all shape the environment a child’s nervous system keeps learning from.

The real question isn’t how to make children perform better. It’s how to raise human beings capable of moving through difficulty without losing themselves. A child is not a problem to be solved but a developing consciousness growing inside a family, a culture, a society. India’s old instinct - observe before reacting, bring awareness before judgement — sits remarkably close to what modern stress biology now confirms. So perhaps the better question isn’t “how do we make this child behave”, but “what is this behaviour trying to tell us?” Asked with patience, that question turns childhood stress from a problem to be eliminated into an invitation — to build calmer homes, kinder schools, and a culture where children are allowed not just to succeed, but to feel safe enough to grow.

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Order Order

SC acquits man in murder case, cites missing links

The Supreme Court on Wednesday acquitted a man, who was convicted of alleged sexual assault and murder of a minor child and served over 16 years of imprisonment, saying there were several "missing links" in the chain of the prosecution case. A bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva held that the trial court had erred in convicting and sentencing him to life imprisonment and the Punjab and Haryana High Court also erred in upholding his conviction.

The SC noted that there was no direct evidence of the offence and the entire case against him was based on circumstantial evidence and the theory of "last seen together". It said there was no "plausible explanation" for the accused making an alleged extra-judicial confession to the village sarpanch, with whom neither he nor the victim had any connection.

"Extra-judicial confession is a weak piece of evidence and per se without any independent and cogent corroborative circumstance or evidence cannot be made the sole basis for conviction," the bench said. It noted that wherever the court, upon due appreciation of entire prosecution evidence, intends to base a conviction on an extra-judicial confession, it must ensure that the same inspires confidence and is corroborated by other evidence.

"If, however, the extra-judicial confession suffers from material discrepancies or inherent improbabilities and does not appear to be cogent as per the prosecution version, it may be difficult for the court to base a conviction on such a confession," the bench noted. The top court delivered its verdict on an appeal filed by the man challenging an October 2022 order of the high court. (PTI)

Delhi HC refuses plea against Vizag airport closures



The Delhi High Court on Wednesday refused to entertain a plea against the closure of Visakhapatnam Airport for commercial flights. A bench of Chief Justice DK Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia said that the petitioner should have approached the Andhra Pradesh High Court with his grievance, as it was the people there who were "suffering" on account of the closure. The counsel for the petitioner urged the bench to call for a reply from the authorities, contending that the "decision" to shut down the airport was taken in Delhi.

"Where is the order impacting people? When parts of the cause of action are in two high courts, it is the dominant high court which determines the forum. The dominant cause of action is in Visakhapatnam. File it there," the court responded. The court also noted that a PIL on the issue is pending in the Andhra Pradesh High Court.

"The petition is dismissed on the ground of forum non conveniens," ordered the bench. The court said the petitioner can approach the Andhra Pradesh High Court with his plea. The petitioner's counsel said the authorities shut down the Vizag airport in an arbitrary and high-handed manner. He emphasised that instead of having two functional airports, a decision was taken to shift all operations to a new airport which was "60 km or two hours away from the most populated city" in the state.

"Suffering was of people of Visakhapatnam, not Delhi," the court told the petitioner's lawyer. Scheduled commercial operations at Visakhapatnam Airport ceased on August 16, following the departure of the last flight, IndiGo 6E 2018 to Delhi, at 10.45 pm. (PTI)

SC quashes conviction of 20-year-old, says child should not be treated as criminal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Observing that "a child should not be treated as a criminal", the Supreme Court on Tuesday set aside the 20-year-old conviction of a man who was a minor at the time of the alleged offence, saying that the procedural finality and "technical shackles" cannot be used to deny statutory benefits to a juvenile.

The top court said that a child is a victim of circumstances and is sometimes drawn to the crime world due to socio-economic or emotional and psychological reasons. "The State owes a responsibility to reintegrate the juveniles in society rather than permanently stigmatise them," a bench comprising Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and

Shree Chandrashekhar said. It referred to unawareness about legal protections available to minors under the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act and said: "The rise in the number of cases coming to this court raising the plea of juvenility for the first time in this court indicates in ample measure that there is a huge gap in the understanding of law by the stakeholders".

It overturned the verdict against the appellant, Mahavir alias Avnish, holding that his conviction for "disappearance of evidence" was not only procedurally flawed but legally unsustainable.

Writing the judgment for the bench, Justice Shree Chandrashekhar referred to the facts of the case to highlight a serious issue hindering the implementation of



Uddhav altered Sena's structure: Shinde camp

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Eknath Shinde-led faction told the Supreme Court on Wednesday that the organisational structure established by Shiv Sena founder Balasaheb Thackeray to prevent the concentration of power in the hands of the party chief and make it more "democratic" was significantly altered by Uddhav Thackeray in 2018.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was told by senior advocate Neeraj Kishan Kaul, appearing for the Shinde-led faction, that the party constitution was submitted to the Election Commission in 1999 after the poll body directed all political parties to place their constitutions on record.

After the demise of Balasaheb Thackeray, the party proceeded to funda-



mentally alter that structure, Kaul submitted.

"One of the principle arguments sought to be raised is that ECI embarked and created an unknown jurisdiction of looking into party Constitution. From 1994 in various orders, ECI has been

writing to all political parties — either through correspondences or through orders passed that you must have democratic constitutions.

"Parties ought to ensure that party constitutions are democratic. Shiv Sena at some stage came and said

that our constitution does not permit elections. ECI convinced Shiv Sena and amended constitution came into being. After that, suddenly in 2018, new constitution emerges," Kaul said.

The senior advocate also submitted that Balasaheb

Thackeray's son Uddhav Thackeray amended the constitution and placed power in the hands of the party chief. He further argued that the party didn't place the amended constitution on the commission's record.

"Our case has been repeatedly that there was discontent in the party. For reasons best known to petitioners, they aligned with those who were diametrically opposite to Shiv Sena. Ultimately, people said this can't go on. Then we made a case that we were original Shiv Sena," Kaul submitted. The senior lawyer told the court that Election Commission has rightly held that the legislative majority was the appropriate test to determine who commands the majority within a political party. The hearing remained inconclusive and will continue on September 15.

The Uddhav Thackeray-led faction had earlier told the

apex court that the use of the name of 'Shiv Sena' and its election symbol by the Eknath Shinde-led group was "illegitimate". The top court was urged to at least prevent the Shinde group from using them if it does not immediately restore the symbol to the Thackeray faction. The bench was also told that the MLAs of the Shinde-led group, facing disqualification proceedings on account of alleged defections, cannot take the defence that they constitute the original political party.

Senior advocates Kapil Sibal and Devadatt Kamat, appearing for the Thackeray faction, had said that recognising the Shinde-led camp as the "real" party would amount to rewarding a "constitutional sin". The bench was hearing two pleas filed in 2024 by the Thackeray faction against the EC's order allotting the 'bow-and-arrow' symbol to the Shinde camp.

Calcutta HC defers hearing on Mahua Moitra's plea

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Wednesday adjourned till September 7 Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra's petition challenging the legality of an arrest warrant issued against her by a court in Nadia district's Krishnanagar.

The high court had on August 24 stayed the arrest warrant that was issued due to Moitra's alleged non-compliance with directions to appear before the magisterial court in Nadia.

A division bench of the high court, headed by Justice Debansu Basak, adjourned the hearing in Moitra's criminal revision application challenging the legality of the arrest warrant against her on a prayer by the parties in the matter.

The bench, also comprising Justice



Aryak Dutt, directed that the matter would be heard on September 7.

The arrest warrant was issued in a case that was filed before the court in Nadia district, where it was alleged that the Krishnanagar MP insulted women and made hate speech.

According to Moitra's lawyer Arko Kumar Nag, since the dates of her

alleged speeches, as mentioned in the complaint, and the filing of the case against her were all during her being a member of Parliament, the case has to be tried before the designated MP/MLA court.

He also maintained that the allegations are baseless and frivolous, and that the complaint's contents cannot be treated as a criminal offence.

A case was filed against Moitra alleging she insulted women and made hate speech, for which pre-cognisance summons were issued to her by the Krishnanagar court.

The third judicial magistrate at Krishnanagar Court, noting that she failed to appear before the court despite repeated summonses, ordered on August 19 that an arrest warrant be issued against Moitra.

SC frowns upon unwritten ban imposed on TN fishermen on purse seine fishing

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday frowned upon the "unwritten ban" imposed by the Tamil Nadu Government on fishermen by not granting access passes for using purse seine nets in the Centre's Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ), and said it is necessary for the Union and the state to abide by the principle of cooperative federalism.

Purse seine fishing is a method that uses a vertical net attached to a vessel to encircle schools of fish in open water.



A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe ruled that the rights and liabilities of the parties will now be governed according to the relevant laws, EEZ Rules, 2025 and the Tamil Nadu Marine Fishing Regulation Rules, 2020.

The bench said laws, rules and regulations addressing

the issue of access to the EEZ for fishing using purse seine nets and transiting through the territorial waters of the state have come into force and are operating. "For effective and efficient implementation of these rules and regulations, it is necessary for the Union and the State

to abide by the principle of cooperative federalism.

"For effective and efficient implementation of these rules and regulations, it is necessary for the Union and the State to abide by the principle of cooperative federalism. The Union as well as the state administration are the duty bearers not only to implement the respective regulations within their province, but also to ensure that the stakeholders have easy access and efficient clearance of their applications to pursue their fundamental rights under Article 19(1)(g) of the Constitution of India, of course subject to reasonable regulations," it said.

Odisha court dismisses helicopter case against Patnaik, Pandian

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhubaneswar

A court here on Wednesday dismissed a criminal revision petition against former Odisha chief minister Naveen Patnaik and ex-IAS officer VK Pandian in an alleged expenditure of around ₹500 crore from the state exchequer by undertaking 300 helicopter tours.

Khurda district sessions Judge Biranchi Narayan Mohanty said the petitioner failed to substantiate any offence, did not follow the mandatory procedure under the Bharatiya Nagarik

Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), and lacked locus standi to file the complaint.

The court also found no illegality in the March 25 order of the Sub-Divisional Judicial Magistrate (SDJM), Bhubaneswar, which dismissed the original complaint. The revision petition was rejected as "devoid of merit," the court order said.

One Sudhir Charan Mohanty had lodged a complaint against Patnaik and his close aide and ex-bureaucrat Pandian at the Capital Police Station here in 2024, alleging that they used heli-



copter tours using government funds without official sanctions. When no FIR was registered, he lodged a complaint at the DCP office and later moved the SDJM's court.

However, the SDJM dismissed the matter on the ground that no cognizable case could be made out.

The complainant then approached the Khurda

District Sessions Court.

Patnaik's lawyer and former Advocate General Ashok Kumar Parija and advocate Sitanshu Mohan Dwivedi submitted before the court that the complainant neither produced any supporting material to justify the allegations. "This court is of the considered opinion that the complaint/petitioner neither made out any case under any of the penal sections referred to in the complaint petition with supported materials nor adhered to the mandatory compliance of Section 173(4) of BNSS, 2023

before presenting the complaint nor he had got any locus-standi to present the complaint," the court said.

Section 173(4) of the BNSS allows one to send a written complaint by post to the Superintendent of Police if a local police station refuses to register an FIR.

"Resultantly, this court does not find any illegality in the impugned order dated 25.03.2026 passed by the learned SDJM, Bhubaneswar in dismissing the petitioner's complaint," the judge said in the order, while dismissing the criminal revision.

death and causing the disappearance of evidence under Section 201 of the IPC.

In 2005, the trial court acquitted the family of murder and dowry death after witnesses turned hostile. However, it convicted Mahavir under Section 201 IPC, sentencing him to three years of rigorous imprisonment. Years later, Mahavir raised a plea of juvenility, asserting he was only 17 years old at the time of the incident.

While a Juvenile Justice Board inquiry confirmed his date of birth as July 1, 1987, making him a minor in 2004, the Madhya Pradesh High Court refused to intervene.

The high court had reasoned that since the case had previously reached the Supreme Court, it lacked the jurisdiction to "reopen" a

settled judgment under Section 482 of the CrPc.

The top court criticised the high court for being "over-cautious" and committing an "error of record".

The bench clarified that Mahavir's earlier petition to the Supreme Court had been withdrawn to specifically seek the plea of juvenility, meaning the case had not attained the kind of "finality" that bars a jurisdictional correction. It reiterated that Section 7A of the juvenile law allows a claim of juvenility to be raised before any court at any time, even after the final disposal of a case.

It said that the state and the courts have a duty to act in the best interests of children and ensure they are not denied legal protections due to a "gap in the understanding of law".



the juvenile law. "We must remember that the impact of industrialisation, urbanisation and migration changed the people's daily lives. They started migrating from rural areas to the cities as a result

of which there was an explosion in population... Poverty, inequality, illiteracy and the discriminatory environment in which a child grows trigger delinquent behaviour in the child, and he

becomes a victim of the crime," the verdict said. The bench said there was a huge gap in the understanding of law by the stakeholders.

"The investigating officers are generally obsessed with the motto to bring the culprit to book, and the courts before whom a juvenile is produced do not focus attention on the assessment of age of the juvenile," it said.

In the process, the mandate of law is overlooked, and the rights of a juvenile in conflict with law get violated; the child becomes a casualty, it said.

"It is well-remembered that children are the greatest assets of any nation and they should be nurtured and grown as responsible citizens, mentally alert, physically fit and morally healthy to contribute to the better-

ment of society," it said. The greatest recompense that the state can gain from expenditure on children is in the form of a powerful human resource which would be ready to take its place in the forward march of the nation, it said.

"In conclusion, the existing system needs further strengthening, effective monitoring of investigative processes and implementation of the statutory provisions," it said.

The matter dates back to September 2004, when a crime was registered in Morena, Madhya Pradesh, following the discovery of the bodies of a woman, Bhuri, and her infant daughter on a railway track.

Mahavir, along with his family members, was charged with murder, dowry

Patra told NCLAT that Chandra he has been vilified across the country over a proposed payment of ₹6.5 crore against admitted creditor claims of ₹22,006 crore even though no final order approving the repayment plan currently exists.

CONSTANT SAME BAGALWA
 Bunia



UNITY

Small Finance Bank

UNITY SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED

5th Floor, Tower 1, Seawoods Grand Central, Sec-40, Seawoods, above Seawoods Darave
Railway Station, Navi Mumbai – 400 706

DEMAND NOTICE

UNDER THE PROVISIONS OF THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 ("the Act") AND THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002 ("the Rules")

The undersigned is the duly authorized officer of **Unity Small Finance Bank Limited** under the Act and in exercise of power conferred under Section 13 (12) of the Act read with the Rule 3, issued Demand Notice(s) under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the following borrower(s) to repay the amount mentioned in the respective notice(s) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The undersigned reasonably believes that borrower(s) is/are avoiding the service of the demand notice(s), therefore the service of notice is being effected by affixation and publication as per Rules. The contents of demand notice(s) are extracted herein below:

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower (s)	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Description of secured assets (Immovable Property)
1	Loan A/C. No(S). : USFBDELLOAN000005011405		
	1. M/s. Genetic Public School, Salawa, Sardhana Meerut Through Its President Shri Deepak Kumar And Secretary Shri Amrish Kumar		
	2. Gauri R (Also Known As Gauri Soam) S/o. Ram Kumar		
	3. M/s. Genetic Trust, Salawa, Meerut Through Its President Shri Deepak Kumar And Secretary Shri Amrish Kumar		
	4. Neha Tomer, W/o. Deepak Kumar		
	5. Deepak Kumar, S/o. Rishpal		
	6. Shri Amrish Kumar		
	7. Shri Sachin Kumar		
	For Sr. No. 1 & 3 : Resident Of Village Mohammad Akbar Chakbandi Abd, Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut.	13.08.2026 Rs. 6,31,95,68.07/- (Rupees Sixty-Three Lakh Nineteen Thousand Five Hundred Sixty Eight and Paise Seven Only) As On	All Piece and Parcel Property Bearing:- Measuring 0.0700 hectare, consisting of khasra number 1315, situated at Village Salawa, Pargana and Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut. Surrounded by Boundaries - North : Road 15 Feet Wide, East : Property of Sher Singh, South : Property of Meghraj, West : Property of Dharamraj
	For Sr. No. 2 & 6 : Resident Of Village Mohammad Akbar Chakbandi Abd, Kapsad Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut.	13.08.2026 NPA Date : 04.04.2025	
For Sr. No. 3 & 4 : Resident Of Village Mohammad Akbar Chakbandi Abd, Kapsad Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut.			
For Sr. No. 4 & 5 : Village Salawa, Pargana And Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut			
For Sr. No. 6 : Measuring 0.0700 Hectare, Consisting Of khasra Number 1315, Situated At Village Salawa, Pargana And Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut.			
For Sr. No. 7 : Treasurer, Genetic Trust Salawa C/O Genetic Trust Salawa, Village Salawa, Tehsil Sardhana, District Meerut, Uttar Pradesh – 250342.			

Place : Delhi
Date : 03.09.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Unity Small Finance Bank Limited

NORTHERN RAILWAY (E-Auction Notice)		
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (https://ireps.gov.in/) for the allotment of Deluxe Pay & Use Toilet Contracts on ROMT & MOT Basis, at following Railway Stations/locations:-		
E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
PaynUse-10-2026	17.09.2026 को 12:00 बजे	Hazrat Nizamuddin (NZM) 03 Sites, Delhi (DL) 01 Site, Anand Vihar (ANVT) 01 Site, Patel Nagar (PTNR) 01 Site, Modinagar (MDNR) 01 Site, Narwana (NRW) 01 Site, Mansa (MSZ) 01 Site, Delhi Sarai Rohilla (DEE)-01 Site, Kurukshetra (KKDE)-01 Site & Panipat 01 Site (PNP), Total 12 Sites.
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen		https://ireps.gov.in/
All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfill following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids. - Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module. - Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Update of Turnover Details. - A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. - Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.		
Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: sanitationcell@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084	
No. 7PUB/TN/Pay&UseToilets/Auction/2022 Customer: 01.09.2026		3016/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE		

Place : New Delhi / Delhi & Jhajjar, Haryana
Date : 29.08.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that my client, Mr. Saroj is in process to purchase the Entire First Floor of Situation of Property Bearing Municipal No. 87/122, 123, 124, 125, U.S. No. yds. out of Khata No. 478/179 of Partion at Chastri Nagar, Delhi 110052 from Mr. Jawant Singh Chauhan by availing the loan from Regional Engineering Pvt. Ltd. That Mr. Jawant Singh Chauhan had acquired the said property after the death of his mother. From Late wife Jyoti, I am in full of disbursement, mortgage (equitable/registered or otherwise), gift, trust, inheritance, family arrangement, maintenance, bequest, partition, possession, lease, sublease, tenancy, license, charge, pledge, easement or otherwise howsoever, or are hereby acquainted to notify the said person(s) with supporting documentary evidence at the address mentioned below within 7 days from the date of publication of this notice. If any of the said person or persons will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned.

Tanaji Khatkhatu Gada (Advocate)
Unit No. FF-2, First Floor, Mahatma Metro Tower
Sec-4, Vaishali, Gzb., U.P., Mob. 9810063351



Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by MR. SUJAY GUPTA
having address at H NO 315 1ST
FLRS RPS FLATS, SHEIKH SARAI
PHASE I MALAVIYA, DELHI -
110017 with **KOTAK MAHINDRA**
BANK Situated at 19, C BLOCK,
COMMUNITY CENTRE
SAFARJUNG DEVELOPMENT
AREA, SDA MARKET, OPP IIT GATE,
NEW DELHI - 110016 remains un-

used for 18 months.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. SUJAY GUPTA** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. SUJAY GUPTA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **02, December 2026** at around 12p.m.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that my client, Subhash Chanderna, is the owner of the Property bearing No. 22/119, 220, 221, U.S. No. yds. out of Khata No. 71/1601, Khata No. 22/119, situated in the area of Village Sikdipura in the abadi Mahalakshmi Chandra, Nag Nagar Extn., Hlaqa of Chastri Nagar, Delhi 110052. Having acquired the said sale deed dated 13.05.2025 (Doc. No. 2025/231/3830) registered by Parveen Kumar Panchal and his wife, whereafter they might be considered to have been waived of their mother Kasturi Devi Will dated 18.10.2021. Moreover they have not obtained the necessary documents to be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned.

Tanaji Khatkhatu Gada (Advocate)
Unit No. FF-2, First Floor, Mahatma Metro Tower
Sec-4, Vaishali, Gzb., U.P., Mob. 9810063351

Bank Ltd., the Secured Creditor's website i.e. <https://www.svcbank.com/Notice-Sale>
Date : 01.09.2026 Sd/- Sarathy Somiah, Authorized Officer
Place : Bengaluru Deputy General Manager, L&R, South Region.

Sri Lanka, Israel among 5 countries converging in Delhi at BLTM 2026

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

BLTM 2026, a B2B trade show focused on business, leisure and MICE travel, opened today at Yashobhoomi, Dwarka, bringing destinations and travel businesses from Sri Lanka, Israel, Saint Petersburg (Russia), Nepal and Thailand, together with the Indian travel market.

The ninth edition brought together 500+ exhibitors from five countries and 18 States & Union Territories, with 300+ hosted buyers and 12,000+ pre-scheduled business meetings. Day 1 recorded a 10 per cent increase in visitor turnout compared with last year's opening day. More than 10,500 qualified trade visitors are expected in the next two days of the event. Registration is complimentary for trade visitors across all three days.

The event was inaugurated by Suneel Anchipaka, IAS, Managing Director, Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation, as Chief Guest and Dheera Hettiarachchi, Chairman, Sri Lanka Convention Bureau, as Guest of Honour.

The inauguration was also attended by distinguished members of the diplomatic community and senior tourism and industry leaders, including HE Mahishini Colonne, High Commissioner of Sri Lanka to India; Oday Hatim Mohammed, Chargé d'Affaires, Embassy of the Republic of Iraq; Penday Dorji, Counsellor (Economic), Royal Bhutanese Embassy; Kapila J Kumara, Minister Counsellor (Commercial), High Commission of Sri Lanka in New Delhi; Vivien Espoir Elengs Maloba, Third Secretary, Embassy of the Republic of the Congo; and Suhail Ahmed, Commercial Specialist, Embassy of the United States of America.

Senior representatives from the travel and MICE industry included Sunil Kumar R, President, Travel Agents Association of India (TAAI); Jagdeep Bhagat, President, Travel Industry Association (TIA); Gajesh Girdhar, Founder & Chairman, Governing Council, Network of Indian



MICE Agents (NIMA); Naveen Rizvi, Vice President, SITE India Chapter; NSN Mohan, Vice President, SKAL International; Dinesh Kummar, Chairman-North India Chapter, TAFI; and Rajesh Arya, President, GAEHP.

Speaking at the event, Suneel Anchipaka, IAS, Managing Director, Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation, said, "Delhi is taking a more collaborative approach to tourism development, with the Delhi Tourism Board bringing Government and industry stakeholders together as equal partners. We are placing greater emphasis on MICE, the concert economy and spiritual and heritage tourism. On the MICE front, we are working towards establishing a dedicated convention bureau to attract more business events to the city. Platforms such as BLTM play an important role in this effort by bringing destinations, tourism boards, MICE planners and industry stakeholders together, creating opportunities for partnerships that can translate into tangible business for Delhi and contribute to India's tourism growth."

Sanjiv Agarwal, Chairman & CEO, Fairfest Media Limited said, "BLTM 2026 reflects the growing opportunity in India's business travel and MICE market, and the increasing interest from destinations and suppliers looking to engage with Indian buyers. With strong international and domestic participation, a curated Hosted

Buyer programme and thousands of pre-scheduled meetings, our focus this year is on enabling purposeful connections that translate into long-term business partnerships. As the industry evolves, BLTM continues to bring the right buyers, destinations and travel businesses together on one focused platform."

The opening day saw buyers and exhibitors engage across MICE, corporate travel, group travel, destination weddings and leisure, with discussions centred on what destinations need to offer to win Indian business, how technology and human engagement are reshaping business events, and how MICE can deliver measurable business outcomes.

The programme featured sessions including "Competing for the Indian MICE Market: What Makes a Destination Win?", "Future Ready Business Events: Innovation, Technology and Human Connection" and "It's Not a Holiday — Redesigning MICE for Real Business Outcomes."

The strong international participation at BLTM comes as India's MICE and business travel opportunity continues to expand, with rising demand for conferences, incentive travel, corporate meetings, destination weddings and premium group travel. BLTM cites India's outbound MICE tourism market as projected to reach USD 13.4 billion by 2031, while the wider India MICE market was valued at USD 49.4 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 103.7

billion by 2030, growing at a CAGR of 13 per cent.

This growing opportunity is reflected in the participation at BLTM 2026, with Sri Lanka as the Partner Country, Israel as the Feature Country and Saint Petersburg as the Focus Destination. Delhi is the Host State, while Odisha and Goa are participating as Partner States and West Bengal, Punjab, and Tamil Nadu as Feature States. The event brings together tourism boards, hotels, resorts, travel companies, convention bureaux and destination management companies with Indian travel trade, corporate buyers, wedding planners and MICE specialists.

Rural tourism also has a dedicated presence at BLTM 2026, with initiatives showcasing rural homestays and authentic village experiences from Madhya Pradesh, Delhi NCR, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. The initiative aims to connect rural tourism enterprises with the travel trade while highlighting local culture, traditional cuisine, handicrafts, nature-based experiences and sustainable livelihood opportunities for local communities.

BLTM's appointment-led format is designed to turn this convergence into business opportunities, with pre-scheduled meetings, a Hosted Buyer programme and speed networking sessions connecting international suppliers with qualified Indian buyers across MICE, corporate travel, leisure, group travel and destination weddings.

BLTM Continues on 3 and 4 September

BLTM 2026 to continue on 3 and 4 September, with further B2B meetings and a programme of industry sessions and networking initiatives. Day 2 will feature "Business Session by NIMA - AI X MICE: From Event Tools to Intelligent Operations," "WeddingSutra Engage: Travel and Destination Weddings 2027," "The Future of MICE: AI, Experiences and New Markets," the B2B Speed Networking Session and TIA Recharge 3.0. Day 3 will conclude with the Valedictory and Awards Function and the Responsible Tourism Awards by ICRT.

Recognise persons with disabilities by their abilities, not disability: Virendra Kumar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Minister for Social Justice and Empowerment Virendra Kumar on Tuesday called for building an inclusive society where persons with disabilities are recognised for their abilities, talent, competence and potential rather than their disability.

He was speaking at the signing ceremony of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPWD), Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, and the Rajyoga Education & Research Foundation (RERF), a sister organisation of Brahma Kumaris, for the launch of the Divyang Samanata, Sanrakshan evam Sashaktikaran Abhiyan (DISSA) at Ambedkar International Centre in New Delhi.

"Our goal must be to build an inclusive society where a person is recognised not by their disability, but by their abilities, talent, competence and potential," Virendra Kumar said. He stressed the need to move beyond a welfare-centric approach



towards one that recognises and nurtures the capabilities and potential of persons with disabilities.

The Minister said that the empowerment of persons with disabilities cannot be achieved through Government efforts alone and requires meaningful participation from society as well as the active engagement of social, spiritual, educational and service-oriented institutions.

He said such partnerships could provide an effective model for taking Government schemes and services to the last mile and ensuring that they reach those who need them most. Referring to the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, he emphasised that laws and schemes can fulfil their true purpose only when their benefits reach every eligible person in a meaningful

and accessible manner.

Virendra Kumar expressed confidence that the experience, outreach and network of RERF and its associated organisations would contribute significantly to the empowerment of persons with disabilities. He also stressed that when a person with a disability is empowered, the benefits extend beyond the individual to the family, society and ultimately the nation.

Minister of State for Social Justice and Empowerment BL. Verma described the occasion as a meaningful step towards social service, equality and inclusion. He said the Government, State Governments, local administrations, families and society at large share a collective responsibility to safeguard the rights and dignity of persons with disabilities

while ensuring equal opportunities for them.

Verma said the focus should not merely be on reducing the difficulties associated with disability, but on recognising the abilities, talents, competencies and potential of persons with disabilities and providing them opportunities to realise their full potential. He expressed confidence that the initiative would strengthen social equality, dignity and inclusion and enable persons with disabilities to participate in the mainstream of national life with confidence and equal opportunity.

Brahma Kumaris highlights 18 years of work

Rajyogini BK Asha didi, Member of the Brahma Kumaris Management Committee, highlighted the organisation's continuous work for the empowerment of persons with disabilities, particularly children and young people, over the past 18 years. She said dedicated programmes and comprehensive training modules have been developed during this period. Two dedicated vans are used by trained teams to reach schools and colleges with the permission and cooperation of local authorities and educational institutions.

CISF holds blood donation drive at NHCC Hospital in Mahipalpur

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), in coordination with the Blood Centre, Main Hospital, AIIMS, Delhi, organised a mega voluntary blood donation drive at the CISF NHCC Hospital in Mahipalpur on Wednesday.

The drive was inaugurated at 11 am by Praveer Ranjan, IPS, Director General, CISF, who led by example by voluntarily donating blood. His participation encouraged senior officers and personnel of the Force to join the initiative. Senior officers, including Inspector General Shri Navajyoti Gogoi, IG Smt. Sonia Narang and IG Vinay Kajla, also donated blood during the drive.

The event was attended by Shri Vijay Prakash, IPS, ADG



(HQrs), Binita Thakur, IPS, ADG (Airports), and Shalini Tiwari, Director Medical, CISF.

The AIIMS team coordinating the camp was led by Poonam Kaushik, HOD, Blood Centre, Main Hospital, AIIMS, Delhi, and Anju AS, Medical Social Welfare Officer, along with the medical team.

Around 500 CISF personnel donate blood

Nearly 500 CISF personnel participated in the voluntary

blood donation drive, reflecting the Force's commitment to public service and community welfare beyond its core security responsibilities.

The participation included personnel from different ranks, with senior officers and jawans coming forward to contribute to the cause.

The initiative assumes significance amid the reported shortage of blood in the national capital. Delhi's daily

requirement is approximately 1,400 units of blood, while around 960 units are currently being made available, resulting in a deficit of nearly 440 units every day.

With the growing population and increasing number of medical and surgical procedures, the demand for blood continues to rise. Since there is no artificial substitute for human blood, voluntary donation remains essential to maintaining adequate supplies and saving patients in critical need.

DG CISF calls for greater participation

Addressing the gathering, DG CISF Praveer Ranjan appreciated the voluntary participation of CISF personnel and said that members of a uniformed force should take the lead in initiatives aimed at serving society.

LIC launches two new insurance plans on 70th anniversary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) has introduced two new insurance plans-LIC's Bima Platinum (Plan 770) and LIC's Jeevan Raksha (Plan 894)-on the occasion of the corporation's 70th anniversary. The two plans were launched on Tuesday by LIC Chairman and Managing Director R Doraiswamy. Both products are scheduled to be available for purchase from September 7, 2026, through both offline and online channels.

LIC's Bima Platinum
LIC's Bima Platinum (Plan 770, UIN: 512N397V01) is a non-participating, non-linked individual plan that combines savings and protection. It is a limited-premium plan that provides Guaranteed Additions of ₹70 per ₹1,000 of annual premium paid during the premium-paying term.



The Guaranteed Additions will accrue at the end of each year during the premium-paying term.

Under the plan, a Booster Income Benefit equivalent to 70per cent of the Basic Sum Assured will be payable if the life assured survives until the end of the fifth year after completion of the premium-paying term.

The plan also provides a Regular Income Benefit equivalent to 10per cent of the Basic Sum Assured at the end of each year during the

payout period, which is the policy term minus the premium-paying term.

The minimum Basic Sum Assured under the plan is 73 lakh, while there is no specified upper limit. The maximum Basic Sum Assured, however, will be subject to acceptance under LIC's Board Approved Underwriting Policy.

The Basic Sum Assured can be selected in multiples of ₹10,000. Policyholders can choose premium-paying terms of 7, 10, 12, 15 or 18 years.

The minimum age at entry is 30 days completed, while the maximum age at entry is 55 years, depending on the premium-paying term selected. The minimum and maximum ages at maturity are 28 years and 75 years, respectively.

LIC said rebates would be available for existing policyholders as well as nominees and beneficiaries of deceased policyholders. Policyholders can also enhance their coverage by opting for available rider benefits.

LIC's Jeevan Raksha

LIC's Jeevan Raksha (Plan 894, UIN: 512N368V01) is a non-participating, non-linked pure risk plan designed to provide financial protection to the family of the insured in the event of death during the policy term.

Haryana Government to expand Kalpana Chawla Medical College Hospital in Karnal at ₹404.95 cr

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Wednesday said that providing better, modern and specialised healthcare facilities closer to the people remains a priority of the State Government.

He said the Government is continuously strengthening healthcare services and medical education facilities in medical colleges and hospitals across the State to ensure that people have access to better treatment, particularly in cases of serious illnesses and medical emergencies.



The CM was chairing a meeting of the State Finance Committee at the Secretariat,

where the Phase-II expansion of Kalpana Chawla Government Medical College and Hospital (KCGMC), Karnal, was discussed.

Under Phase-II, the medical facilities and capacity of the hospital will be substantially expanded, enabling people from Karnal and adjoining areas to access better specialised and super-specialty healthcare services.

70,584 corruption complaints received against Government departments in 2025

ASHWINI SHRIVASTAVA
■ New Delhi

More than 70,500 corruption complaints were received against Government bodies in 2025, with banks and the Railways accounting for the highest number of complaints, according to the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) annual report. Of the 70,584 complaints received by Chief Vigilance Officers (CVOs), who act as the Commission's distant arm, 64,905 complaints were disposed of as on December 31, 2025, the report said.

The remaining 5,679 complaints were under process at the end of the year, including 2,002 complaints



pending for more than three months, according to the CVC Annual Report 2025.

CVOs are expected to complete investigations into complaints within three months. The Commission conducts periodic reviews of complaints pending with CVOs to ensure their expeditious disposal, the report said.

Banks, Railways receive maximum complaints

CVOs of banks received the highest number of complaints at 9,933, of which 9,520 were disposed of and 413 remained pending, including 52 for more than three months. The Railways received 9,381 complaints, of which 8,754 were disposed of and 627 were pending as on December 31, 2025. Of the pending complaints, 10 had remained unresolved for more than three months.

A total of 6,531 complaints were related to the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, while 4,834 complaints were against local bodies, excluding the Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi (GNCTD).

The local bodies include the Delhi Jal Board (DJB), Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd (DSIIDC), Delhi Transco Limited (DTL), Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC), Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB), Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC), Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC). (PTI)

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(REGD. OFFICE: PSEB HEAD OFFICE, THE MALL, Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813
(Contact No 96461-07129)

Tender Inquiry No. 04/TLC/BTI/2026-27 Dated: 02/09/2026
DV CE/TL Circle, PSPCL Officer's House No. B-14, Thermal Colony, Bathinda Invites E-tender for Replacement/augmentation of existing 66kV Line from 66kV Bhagta to Jalal on Multi ckt tower from TL-01 to TL-03 (TWL no. 67/WZ/2025-26 Annex-B). For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 03/09/2026 from 9.00 AM onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

C843/26

1079/12/2026-27/14800 Dated CHD :- 02/09/2026

verka
THE PUNJAB STATE COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS FEDERATION LTD.
SCO 153-155, SECTOR 34-A, CHANDIGARH-160022, EPABX NO. 0172-5041812,66
Notice Inviting Tender
www.verka.coop

Sr. No.	Name of Work/Item	Period/Tentative Qty
1.	For Verka Jalandhar Dairy a) Hiring of the services of one Part-Time Factory Medical Officer (MBS) along with one qualified Dresser-cum-Compounder. b) Outsourcing of all activities of city supply despatch dock.	Two Year One Year

NOTE:
1. For complete details regarding above tender (NIT), please visit our website i.e. www.verka.coop & e Tendering portal i.e. eproc.punjab.gov.in.
2. Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only.

General Manager (Purchase)

1018/12/2026-27/14798

JITF INFRALOGISTICS LIMITED
CIN NO. : L60231CT2008PLC016434
Registered Office: A-11 (7), Udyia Society, Sector-3, Tatibandh, Dharsiaa, Raipur- 492099, Chhattisgarh, India,
Website: www.jindalinfralogistics.com, E-mail: contactus@jindalinfralogistics.com

NOTICE OF THE EXTRA ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING

Notice is hereby given that the Extra Ordinary General Meeting ("EGM") of the Company will be held on **Thursday, 1st October 2026 at 12.30 P.M.** at A-1, UPSIDC Industrial Area, Nandgaon Road, Kosi Kalan, District Mathura-281403, (U. P.) to transact the business as set out in the Notice of Extra Ordinary General Meeting. The notice of EGM has been sent to the members who hold shares as on record date, i.e., 28th August 2026, by email, whose email is registered with the Company/Depository(s) and the physical copy to all the other members. The said documents can also be viewed on the company's website at www.jindalinfralogistics.com.
Further, pursuant to the provisions of section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with rule 20 of Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and regulation 44 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company is providing remote e-voting facility to its members to cast their vote electronically on the resolutions to be transacted at EGM of the Company.
The member please note the followings:
a. The remote e-voting shall commence at 9.00 a.m. on Monday, 28th September 2026 and shall end at 5.00 p.m. on Wednesday, 30th September 2026.
b. The remote e-voting shall not be available beyond 5.00 p.m. on Wednesday, 30th September 2026.
c. The cut-off date for determining the eligibility of members for remote e-voting and voting through poll at EGM is 25th September 2026.
d. Any person who becomes member of the Company after dispatch of notice of the meeting and holding shares as on cut-off date i.e. 25th September 2026, may obtain the user id and password by contacting RCMC Shares Registry (Pvt.) Ltd., R & T Agent of the Company at B-25/1, Okhla Industrial Area Phase II, New Delhi – 110020, phone-011-26387320-21, Fax-011-26387322, Email-evoting.services@rcmdltdelhi.com.
e. The members who cast their vote through remote e-voting may also attend the EGM but shall not be allowed to cast their vote at EGM.
f. The facility of voting through poll shall be available at the EGM to those members who have not casted their vote through remote e-voting.
g. Members may go through the e-voting instructions provided in the EGM Notice or visit <https://evoting.nsdl.com> and in case of any queries, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for members and e-voting User Manual for members available at the download section of <https://evoting.nsdl.com>
For JITF Infralogistics Limited
Sd/-
Alok Kumar
Company Secretary
ACS-19819

Place: New Delhi
Date: 02.09.2026

BRIEFLY

MYAS announces Tenzing Norgay awards 2024



Mountaineer Baljeet Kaur, who became the first Indian to scale five 8,000-metre peaks in a single season, is among the four winners of the Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Awards for the year 2024, the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports announced on Wednesday.

The awards recognise outstanding achievements by individuals in the field of adventure and seek to "promote a spirit of endurance, risk-taking, teamwork and quick and effective decision-making in challenging situations."

Baljeet had achieved this feat in 2022, and a year later, the 30-year-old had hit the headlines again for scaling Mount Annapurna, which is the 10th highest peak in the world. She had gone missing after scaling the peak and was rescued after 19 hours.

(PTI)

Dhruv Sitwala clinches silver at Pan Am Cup championship



India's Dhruv Sitwala settled for a silver medal after losing 972-1500 against Singapore's Peter Gilchrist in the final of the Pan Am Cup billiards championship in Winnipeg, Canada. The reigning Asian billiards champion, Sitwala, had started the game in a commanding manner but could not maintain his advantage. Sitwala was up by 450 points in the initial stages of the final but allowed the advantage to slip away from him.

Sitwala had beaten Gilchrist in the New Zealand Open final a couple of years ago but has struggled against him in recent times.

Gilchrist came up with three double-century breaks in quick succession to edge ahead, and even as Sitwala got a few chances in his favour, he failed to capitalise.

(PTI)

Fans flock to book India-Brazil match tickets

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kolkata

Kolkata's football-crazy fans have responded with overwhelming enthusiasm to the much-anticipated India-Brazil friendly next month, with the lower-priced tickets for the once-in-a-lifetime encounter selling out within an hour of going online on Wednesday.

India will take on five-time world champions Brazil on October 3, with football fever already reaching a crescendo in the city, renowned for its passionate following of the sport and the Brazil national team. Ticket prices range from ₹999 to ₹15,000. While the exact number of tickets made available on Wednesday could not be ascertained, the lower-priced slabs were snapped up within an hour of the online window opening on District in for the match at the Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan (VYBK).

The tickets are priced at ₹999, ₹2,000, ₹2,500, ₹3,500, ₹4,500, ₹6,000, ₹7,000, ₹9,000 and ₹15,000 for VIP seats.

The VYBK has a seating capacity of around 67,000, with 70 per cent of the seats expected to be put on



sale. The Indian side will also face Panama and two-time world champions Uruguay in a high-profile friendly series.

India will host Panama on September 26 at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium in Bengaluru before travelling to Kolkata to take on Brazil and then Uruguay on October 6. Tickets for the Brazil match were put on sale online, with no counter sales. This time, the All India Football

Federation (AIFF) will not issue physical tickets, with all passes being provided in digital format, as was done during the FIFA World Cup.

India coach Khalid Jamil has already named a 26-member squad for the FIFA friendlies, with the national camp scheduled to begin in Bengaluru on September 14. The team will travel to Kolkata on September 28, two days after the Panama game.

PLAYING BRAZIL, URUGUAY WILL BE TURNING POINT FOR INDIAN FOOTBALL: HEAD COACH KHALID JAMIL

SUMAN RAY

New Delhi

Playing five-time world champions Brazil and two-time winners Uruguay at home is a dream come true moment and will prove to be a turning point in the history of Indian football, believes the team's head coach Khalid Jamil. Jamil feels the matches will help India prepare for next year's all-important Asia Cup qualifiers.

"Yes, it will be a turning point for Indian football. We are playing Brazil for the first time in history. We must think positively. We must focus on only one thing. India must go ahead."

"Our main target is next year, 2027, Asia Cup qualification. Before that, we are playing with



strong teams. This is a very good thing happening for Indian football," Jamil told PTI in an interview on Wednesday.

"I think, more than anything else, this is history for India. If anybody talks negatively, he must stop. We need support from the fans. I feel that if the crowd supports India 100 per cent, the players will be motivated and will perform well," he observed. (PTI)

Tiger Woods pleads no contest in reckless driving case

DANIEL KOZIN

Stuart (Florida, USA)

Tiger Woods entered a plea agreement Wednesday to a reckless driving charge following a rollover crash in March near his home in Florida.

Woods appeared in a courtroom in Martin County, where he agreed to a reduced charge after he was initially charged with DUI. A judge ordered that his driver's license be suspended for five years.

Woods, 50, said little during the hearing and beforehand sat at the defence table, looking back at the courtroom gallery. He arrived at the courthouse with his girlfriend, Vanessa Trump, President Donald Trump's former daughter-in-law. She sat behind him during the hearing.

The golf legend previously pleaded not guilty to a driving under the influence charge. Woods was arrested after his SUV clipped a truck and rolled over on its side on a beachside residential road on Jupiter Island. A sheriff's report said deputies found two pain pills in his pocket and he showed signs of impairment. He did a Breathalyzer test, which came out negative, but refused to take a urine test.

Neither Woods nor the person in the



other vehicle was injured in the crash, according to officials. But his Land Rover caused \$5,000 in damage to the truck, according to a police report. Woods had told a deputy that he was looking down at his phone and changing the radio station when he hit the truck.

Woods is among the most influential figures in golf, but his career has been derailed by multiple back and knee surgeries, car crashes and dependence on pain medication.

Woods has been involved in four crashes over the years. He took a leave from the golf tour after the 2009 crash and again after the latest crash and has yet to return to tournament play. (AP)

Lakshya Sen crashes out; Srikanth, Tanvi advance in China Masters



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Shenzhen

Lakshya Sen was knocked out of the China Masters after a listless performance in the opening round, but Kidambi Srikanth and Tanvi Sharma registered straight-game wins to progress to the second round of men's and women's singles competition here on Wednesday.

Lakshya, a 2021 World Championships bronze-medalist, played an error-riddled game to go down 14-21, 7-21 in 38 minutes to world Number 9 Canada's Victor Lai, who won his second bronze medal at the World Championships last month.

It was Lakshya's third defeat to the Canadian, with his only

win being at the All England Championships in March this year.

Srikanth, a 2021 World Championships silver-medalist, however, progressed after beating Chinese Taipei's Chi Yu Jen 21-16, 21-15 in another men's singles opener.

The former World Number 1 Indian, who reached the US Open final this year, will face Lai next.

Tanvi, who won her maiden BWF World Tour title at the Taipei Open last month, defeated Denmark's Amalie Schulz 21-16 21-17 to also advance to the women's singles second round.

The 17-year-old from Punjab, a bronze medallist at the Junior World Championships in Guwahati last year, will face Japan's Tomoka Miyazaki next.

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty, a two-time world championships bronze winner, also moved to the next round with a 21-11, 21-16 win over Malaysia's Junaidi Arif and Kang Khai Xing.

The Asian Games gold medallist pair will next take on the Popov brothers — Christo and Toma Junior — of France.

Donyell Malen scoring goals for Roma at espresso-fuelled rate

ANDREW DAMPFAP

Rome

Donyell "Bobby" Malen carefully parked a three-wheel Piaggio Ape before sitting down in front of an espresso to declare he was staying at Roma in a social media video that went viral. Three months later, it's clear again why Malen is attracting so much attention in the Eternal City.

The Netherlands centre-forward has scored five goals in Roma's opening two matches to raise his total to 19 in 20 games since joining the Giallorossi on loan from Aston Villa in January.

Only two players in Italian league history have scored more in their first 20 matches: Gunnar Nordahl (1949) and Jose Altafini (1958-59) with 20 each. And nobody had scored five in the opening two rounds since Gabriel Batistuta for Fiorentina in 1997.

Three years later, Batistuta transferred to Roma and helped lead the capital club to the



Serie A title in 2001.

Now, for the first time in years — decades, actually — Roma appears to have put together a squad capable of competing for the title again. With two wins, eight goals scored and none conceded, it tops the table.

Most of Malen's goals are of the

pure finishing style, with only one or two touches before depositing the ball in the net. He needed only one touch for both of his goals in a 4-0 rout at Lecce on Monday, and used a backheel touch to set up the first score of a hat trick in another 4-0 win, over Fiorentina, in Roma's opener. (AP)

WSK Final Cup: Atiqa Mir records two top-four finishes

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Franciacorta (Italy)

Indian racing prodigy Atiqa Mir overcame setup issues to collect two impressive top-four finishes in Round 1 of the WSK Final Cup here, continuing her upward trajectory in the world of karting. The qualifying session didn't go as per plan for the 11-year-old, and she could only set the ninth-fastest time.

However, the first Indian to be backed by the FI Academy made flying starts in both Race 1 and Race 2 to charge through the field and secure a creditable back-to-back fourth place.



Following the two Heat Races, Atiqa was classified P14 among as many as 72 drivers.

This put her on seventh grid position for the pre-final, where she eventually finished ninth after running fifth for the majority of the race. In the final, Atiqa was involved in a crash

that damaged her kart and ended her race.

"A mixed weekend for me. I was expecting more, but we were struggling for pace. I managed to fight my way up in most of the races and was in a competitive spot for the pre-finals and finals.

DAILY SUDOKU

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.



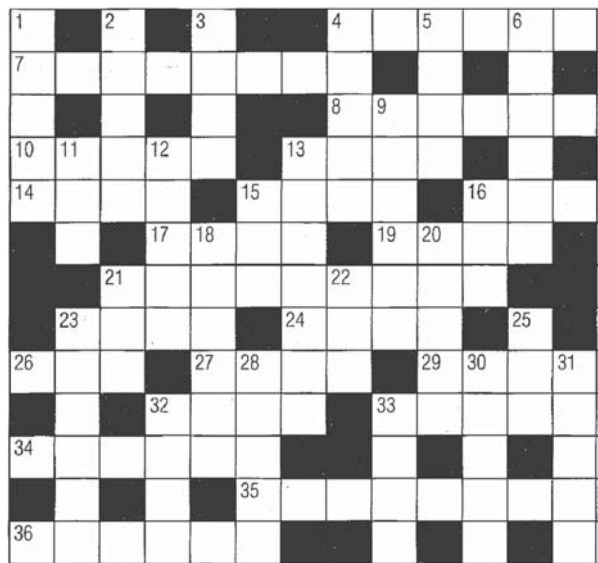
No. SS2234 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

SOLUTION (2.9.26)

9	4	8	7	2	1	5	3	6
6	5	7	4	3	8	2	9	1
2	3	1	9	6	5	7	8	4
3	7	9	6	8	2	1	4	5
1	8	6	5	9	4	3	7	2
5	2	4	1	7	3	8	6	9
8	6	3	2	5	9	4	1	7
7	1	5	3	4	6	9	2	8
4	9	2	8	1	7	6	5	3

No. SS2234 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DOUBLE CROSSWORD
THURSDAY | SEPTEMBER 3, 2026



ACROSS

- 4 He fared badly, holding the money (6)
7 A timepiece? (4,4)
8 It hurts an artist to be in a whirl! (6)
10 Initially right in hand (5)
13 Charge too much for a gloss finish on wood (4)
14 Unfasten a reef knot? (4)
15 The lads appear in person, sometimes (4)
16 A little exercise can stimulate the memory (3)
17 The last thing that may be turned? (4)
19 Read a bit of scandal (4)

DOWN

- 1 Cut an inch off a bird's tail for fun (5)
2 She makes a clear difference (5)
3 Worn out, maybe, but have a try (4)
4 Bad ignition (5)
5 Piece of cutlery in the road? (4)
6 Great inventor with no side about him (6)
9 Overtaken and given the ball (6)
11 Desiree's passion (3)
12 Became established anew in part of Westminster (3,2)
13 He alone, one day, showed wisdom (7)
15 On paper, an assurance of accuracy (3)
16 A bird? Yes, with a pretty tail (3)

- 21 Somewhere to dance, indeed, can be quite a find (9)
23 Quantities going to the ends of the earth! (4)
24 Compelled to give cheese back (4)
26 Reproachful sound from that little old king (3)
27 Swan river (4)
29 So mysteriously shut (4)
32 Figure on being a hero (4)
33 Prepare anew to get a back number (5)
34 Walk the street with a sailorly gait (6)
35 Quotations from former writings (8)
36 Her decapitated foes were brave men

- 18 Attack instead of going on a voyage? (6)
20 Island of secret exoticism? (5)
21 The little girl I had when small (3)
22 Beethoven's vehicle? (3)
23 Creature turned upside down (6)
25 Naturally sticky semi-rubber solution (3)
28 After a heady victory, the little beasts lose badly (5)
30 Something to do with an incubator (5)
31 Keep quiet about mum's accident (5)
32 Crazy and motiveless! (4)
33 It's hard to find the right amount of land (4)

SOLUTION (2.9.26)

- ACROSS
1. Deuces
7. Here—ward
8. Ta—ta
10. Loofah
11. Sol—ace
14. Sty
16.Rid—er
17. A—shy
19. Worse
21. Can—O—e

22. Cadge
23. Spot
26. Sabot
29. Trader
30. Jan—gle
31. O—g—le
32. Ling—Erie
33.Va—c—hts

- DOWN
1. Dahlia
2. Crafty
3. Shah
4. Re—Morse
5. Sail—AD
6. Adder
8.To—sh
9. TA—y
12. Lie
13. Cell—O

15. SO—NG—S
18. Sugar
19. Wad
20.Roe
21. Caterer
22. Cod
23. Senlac
24. Page
25. Treads
26. St.—ill
27. Bar—NS
28. Lag
30. Joey



At BCCI meet, Agarkar, Gambhir seek clarity on injured players' returns

KUSHAN SARKAR ■ New Delhi

(PTI) Injury management of key players heading into a crucial all-format tour of New Zealand and the broader roadmap for next year's ODI World Cup will be the key points of discussion at a BCCI review meeting featuring head coach Gautam Gambhir and chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar in Mumbai on Thursday. The June-July debacle in the UK is expected to be discussed at length, but it is also understood that stakeholders, including BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia, want to look ahead.

Centre of Excellence head VVS Laxman is also expected to join the meeting. The tour of New Zealand is scheduled in October-November.

Injury-Related Timelines

Those tracking the latest developments in Indian cricket say Agarkar and Gambhir could have some very specific queries on the injured centrally-contracted and targeted players who are



undergoing rehabilitation at the Bengaluru-based COE.

"The selection committee chief was informally intimidated before the Sri Lanka Tests that Jasprit Bumrah would be fit for at least one, if not two, Tests. In fact, he had written a mail to COE seeking more clarity on Bumrah's absence.

"His (Bumrah's) absence was felt in the second Test, where Siraj looked distinctly off-colour on a placid track. Ditto for Hardik Pandya, who hasn't played anything post IPL and is important as

far as the ODI World Cup is concerned," a BCCI source told PTI on conditions of anonymity.

While it is very difficult to set a specific date for any player's return as bodies are different and so are the types of injuries, at times, the COE's Sports Science team has often failed to provide even an approximate timeline.

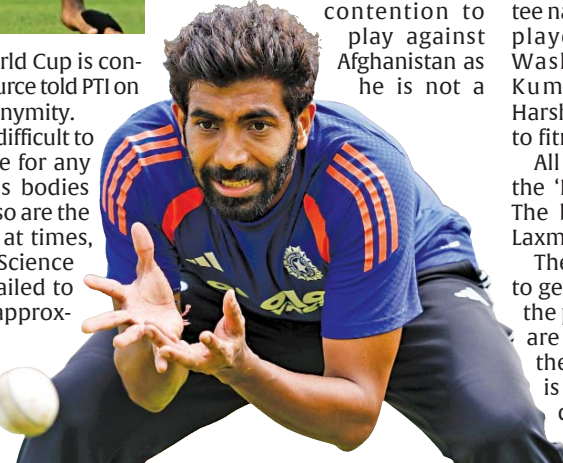
For Agarkar and Gambhir, it is very necessary that they

have an idea about some of the important players' availability, which is central to the strategic planning for marquee tours and big ICC events.

For instance, Pandya has shifted his base to Bengaluru, got a house on rent and plans to train there in the near future.

However, the team management and the selection committee are clear that unless COE rules him fit to bowl 10 overs, they won't pick him for 50-over cricket.

Pandya was never in contention to play against Afghanistan as he is not a



part of the Asian Games squad.

Pacer Akash Deep has been at the COE for several months now and has not played any international cricket. There are questions about his availability against New Zealand A before the start of the Test series. If one looks at the squad selected for the three-match T20I series against Afghanistan scheduled to be played in New Delhi starting September 13, the selection committee named four injured players — Bumrah, Washington, Nitish Kumar Reddy and Harshit Rana — subject to fitness.

All four are following the 'Return to Play' protocols. The ball is now firmly in the Laxman-led COE's court.

The challenge for COE is now to get these injured players on the park by ensuring that they are fit enough to go through the match simulation, which is the last step before COE declares a player fit.

(PTI)



Gill, Bumrah slip; Padikkal moves up in ICC Test rankings



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dubai

Captain Shubman Gill slipped two positions among batters, and Jasprit Bumrah dropped one spot down among bowlers, while Devdutt Padikkal rose to the 54th spot among Indians in the latest ICC Test rankings released on Wednesday.

Gill, who returned with only one half-century across three innings on the Sri Lanka tour, slipped two positions to reach ninth, as wicketkeeper-batter Rishabh Pant remains the highest-ranked Indian batter in Test cricket at seventh.

There was no change in position for Yashviji Jaiswal as the Indian opener is ranked outside the top 10 at 11th.

Padikkal, who was India's best batter on the tour of the Island nation with 328 runs across two Tests with two centuries, moved up five places to reach the 54th position.

Tilak Varma guides South Zone to Duleep Trophy final

G UNNIKRIISHNAN ■ Bengaluru

Skipper Tilak Varma played a second successive influential knock, guiding South Zone to the Duleep Trophy final with a seven-wicket win over North Zone on the fourth and final day of the semifinal on Wednesday. Chasing 181, South Zone got the job done in the first two sessions of the day after Tilak (51 not out) and Ravichandran Smaran (32 not out) milked 80 runs for the unbroken fourth-wicket stand.

South ended with 182 for three towards the end of the second session, and they will face East Zone in the title clash in Chennai from September 6.

Tilak, who had made an unbeaten 116 in the first innings to help South gain a match-clinching 117-run lead, came to the middle when his side was wobbling at 102 for three.

But the left-hander, who is also India's vice-captain for the upcoming T20I series against Afghanistan, once again displayed temperament and technique to counter North bowlers led by fiery pacer Gurnoor Brar and the wily left-arm spinner Abid Mushtaq. Brar tested his resolve with a series of rib-crackers while Mushtaq exploited the variable bounce on the pitch to challenge Tilak's footwork. He aced those challenges spectacularly, essaying some sumptuous drives on the off-side.

Once he settled down, Tilak played a reverse sweep and paddle sweep off Mushtaq to take South closer to the target. Smaran, at the other end, was an able ally, rotating the strike with efficiency and occasionally



freeing his hands. The young left-hander's cracking off-drive off Nishant Sindhu was a sight for sore eyes. Both south-paws' confident knocks meant that South also overcame early dismissals of Narayan Jagadeesan (43) and Ricky Bhui (42), who added 64 runs for the

LOST & FOUND

I, Asha Sharma W/o late sh Ashok Kumar Sharma R/o E-6, Galaxy Apartment, F-Block, Vikasuri, New Delhi-110018, have lost the following property-related DDA documents:DDA LG Rohini Scheme No. 33650 dated 30.03.1981, Rohini Registration Receipt No. RKP/649, Application No. 166382 and DDA FDR Priority No. 17665. Plot no 378 pocket A4 sector 34 Rohini Delhi Finder may contact at the above address.

FORM NO. INC-26

[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules,2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules,2014
AND
In the matter of RV5 Exim Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: "53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"

For and on Behalf of
Kashmira Estates Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323

Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

FORM NO. INC-26

[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules,2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the company from one state to another
Before the Central Government (Regional Director, Northern Region Directorate I, New Delhi)
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of Convenience Enterprises Private Limited, having its registered office at 53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

-----Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an Application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on Thursday the 13th Day of August, 2026 to enable the Company to change its Registered office from the National Capital Territory of Delhi to State of Haryana. Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below: "53/25, 3rd Floor (Front Side), Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005"

For and on Behalf of
Convenience Enterprises Private Limited
Sd/-
(Sonali Anand) Director
DIN: 02540323

Date: 03.09.2026
Place: New Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location	Improvement by SITC of misc items in Tower wagon.
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 48,60,780/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 97,200/-
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	16.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 30.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	30.09.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6	Fund Allocation	07041032
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
E-TENDER No.: 29-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Date: 02.09.2026		3030/2026
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PUBLIC NOTICE

Sunil Kumar Agarwal has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., Green Park Extension, New Delhi, (Bank) to avail a Loan for purchase of Entire First Floor without Roof rights (Said Floor), built on Property No. W-131, Land Area Measuring 400 Square Yards, situated at Greater Kailash Part-II, New Delhi/110048 (property) from Inder Mohan Setia, who has represented that he is the absolute owner of the said property by virtue of Sale Deed dated 28.02.1974 (Doc. No. 1243) executed by executed by M/s DLF United Limited in favor of Mr. Inder Mohan Setia and the said conveyance deed has been misplaced/lost, he also declare that he has not taken any type of Loan, CG Limit or OD Limit on the said property, if anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said Property by way of inheritance, mortgage, sale, or on the basis of lost documents or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 15 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property. please contact Advocate Shupander Kumar, Ph. no. 8296949981 & Email - Legal@riddhisocio.in # 1591, SECTOR 16-17, HISAR WITHIN 15 DAY OF THIS PUBLICATION.

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of the president of India, Sr. Division Signal & Telecom Engineer, Hyderabad Division, South Central Railway, Secunderabad invites open tenders for the following works through e-Procurement up to 11.30 Hours of 23.09.2026

SI. No. : 1, Tender No. Y/SG/36/2026-27/17 Tender Dated 31.08.2026, **Name of the work: Hyderabad Division: Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for WESTRACE-MKII based disturbed Electronic Interlocking (EI) System of make M/s. SIEMENS Rail Automation Pvt. Ltd., Provided at Nizamabad Station in Hyderabad Division for a period of one year., Tender Value (Rs.): 17,19,901.00, EMD (Rs.): 34,400.00**
For bid document and other details log in to <https://ireps.gov.in>. Any corrigendum issued online only.
Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom A719 Engineer/ Hyderabad
For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTHERN RAILWAY (E-Auction Notice)

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in>) for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Catalogue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advt-Sept-03-26	Vinyl Stickers/ Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 22479/80 and 22485/86	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	DDIS UTS	290 UTS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	DDIS PRS	165 PRS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	Advertising on Station Premise (Digital)	Shakur Basti	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	Advertising on Station Premise (Non-Digital)	Shakur Basti	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	Head Rest Covers	Train No. 22439/40, 22435/36, 22447/48, 22469/70 & 22425/26	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-E, C, F & D	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	Unipole	Modinagar.	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-03-26	Waiting Rooms	Baghpat Road, Shamli, Khakra, & Mansa, Railway Station	Start: 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-04-26	Passenger Announcement System (PAS)	New Delhi, Delhi, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Anand Vihar Terminal, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Karnal, Kurukshetra, Panipat, Sonapat, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Muzaffarnagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Rohtak, Delhi Shahdara, Faridabad, Palwal.	Start: 17.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-04-26	Procurement and Supply of Linen Bag	Reserved Coaches of Mail/Express Trains of Delhi Division.	Start: 17.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Sept-04-26	Rail Coach Restaurant	Chanakya Puri	Start: 17.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen : https://ireps.gov.in/ (E-Auction-Leasing)			

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3026/2026